META-PROGRAMS

PERCEPTUAL GENIUS

Meta-Programs—
Essential Thinking Patterns

A Master Practitioner Module

L. Michael Hall, Ph.D.

Updated 2018

Title Page

META-PROGRAMS

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Based on the book — *Figuring Out People*, Revised Edition, ©2005

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META-PROGRAMS

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Introduction

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The field of NLP introduced the subject of *Meta-Programs* in the early 1980s as *thinking and perceiving patterns* that are typically unnoticed, even invisible, and which have pervasive influence on the way we think, what we think, and the quality of our thinking. To study, learn, understand, and manage meta-programs therefore puts into your hands a model that will enrich the way you communicate, relate, influence, lead, manage, parent, coach, and so on.

The domain of *Meta-Programs* enables you to look at your own thinking patterns and those of others in terms of the perceptual lens that we use to see and perceive reality as we do. They are like glasses for looking at reality. What kind of lens do you use as you *see* yourself, others, business, love, etc.?

The *design* of this training is to enable you to—

- Detect the lens or patterns that you and others use.
- Match those thinking styles to create better understanding, communicating, coaching, leading, persuasion, negotiating, etc.
- Identify and change the perceptual frames for facilitating change, development , etc.
- Transform and/or expand the lens that you have for greater perception.
- "Read" people (their meta-programs), hence how they operate as a person (their personality).

Effective communication, coaching, managing, and influencing requires that we know how to "read" people (detect their frames)— those that govern their style of thinking, emoting, and behaving. That's because each of us lives in our own world of thinking style that creates our sense of reality. As we do, we see the world as optimists or pessimists, specifically or globally, looking for procedures or options, etc. What *Meta-Programs* gives you is the ability to detect and then respond to the unique perceptual pattern of those you interact with. When you are able to do that, you will be able to have, as it were, X-ray vision into yourself and others.

This training is based on the best selling book, *Figuring Out People* (Hall and Bodenhamer). It is designed to help you learn to recognize your own meta-programs and then to detect those of others as they communicate. Then you can use these patterns for profiling people and experiences, get a deep rapport with people, discover how to use them to make your messages more persuasive. In the training, you will play the board game, *The Meta-Detective Game* as a way to have fun learning the meta-programs.

This training is also one of the Modules of the NLP Master Practitioner Certification. Completion of these three days completes the Meta-Program Module.

EXCUSE ME,
YOUR META-PROGRAMS ARE SHOWING!

It's not *news* that we call walk around with glasses on, with perceptual lens, even with blinders. Any exchange of communication on any day of the week reveals that. These *glasses* are made up of all of our internal maps, values, beliefs, experiences, understandings and in a word, our "model of the world." We *see* the world, other people, and the situations in our lives *in terms of our mental ideas, concepts, and beliefs.* In NLP, we call these lens *meta-programs.*

Meta-Programs are not unlike our programs for reading, writing, knowing a marshal art, driving a car, reading a financial report, playing a piano, running an NLP pattern, effectively delegating jobs within a business, etc. While these are primary level *content* programs that we learn through school or experience, meta-programs are *structure or process* programs that we also learn. But there are differences. We *learn* meta-programs more covertly and unconsciously. And these are the higher or *meta*-programs govern *how we pay attention, what we pay attention, our style of perceiving, our focus of attention, and the quality of our perceptions.*

The simplest meta-program is one that everybody knows: The "glass half-empty, half-full" perspective. One person *sees, perceives, notices, sorts, and pays attention* to the amount of liquid as being half-empty. The person wears "half-empty" glasses. Another person operates with different glasses: the glass is "half-full." The reality "out there" is the same. Yet the *way* each *sees* it indicates that different meta-programs govern, guide, and direct each person's attention.

> ***The meta-program is the hidden, behind-the-scenes structure which actually controls what and how each person sees.***

This does *not* mean the perception is reality or mere projection. That is an oversimplification and far too black-or-white. It fails to see the interaction between reality "out there" and the frames we bring to it. That is one meta-program. The optimistic/pessimistic perceptions that lead some to anticipate worst-case scenarios and others best-case scenarios is only one of 60 some meta-programs.[1]

The Practicality of Meta-Programs

Recognizing that we walk through the world with different perceptual glasses makes the domain of Meta-Programs useful, important, practical, and even critical. If meta-programs are the hidden factors within or behind our thinking and perceiving, then—

> *meta-programs provide critical leverage points for communicating, relating, negotiating, selling, understanding, changing, transforming, loving, forgiving, and every other human interaction.*

No wonder meta-programs play a key role in "reading people." If we don't know what glasses a person is wearing, or when someone changes glasses, we won't know what or how they are seeing. We won't know what's on their mind or what they are attending. Their experiences will be a mystery to us. Conversely, recognizing meta-programs gives you *an inside understanding* of what's going on and how to create rapport with them. Often, it is a person's meta-programs that simply need some adjustment to take their skills to a new level, to enrich their relationships, to solve decade old problems, and to transform their personality.

Coach to a Person's Meta-Programs

The executive coach, Barbara, that I was mentoring came complaining terribly about a new assignment. She has been assigned as the executive coach to an up-and-coming new senior manager and was excited to get started. But after the first session with Mr. Rodgers her excitement transformed into dread and she told me, "I knew I had just contracted for three months of Tuesday morning struggle."

The problem? Jim's view of things was not only draped with fear, always entertaining the worst case scenario, but his level of attention was on the most minute details, most of which were irrelevant. When I inquired of Barbara about the new position that Mr. Rodgers had been given, she said it was an a senior management level dealing with customer relations and long-term strategic planning for new products.

"What did he do prior to this assignment?" I inquired. It turned out that he had been in quality control where his department made superior gains leading to increases in productivity and reduction of returns.

Barbara was new to the domain of Meta-Programs having begun her study of them, so I decided to focus my mentoring by coaching her own discovery and use of them in this situation.

"Barbara, I want you to step back from what you've just said and I'd like you to see how many meta-programs you just gave me about Mr. Jim Rodgers. How many do you immediately recognize?"

> "Hmmmm. I had not thought of that. So, let's see. Well, there is obviously the negative meta-program of seeing the cup half-empty. Mr. Rodgers certainly sees things in a negative and catastrophic way. He's always anticipating the worst. I guess that's what made him so effective as a Quality Control person."

Great! Not only did you recognize the meta-program of Worst-Case Scenario, you recognized it's implications in terms of his skills and job performance. What else?

> Hmmmm. [Pause] Oh, yes, details. He is a detail person. He doesn't see the big picture, the global, but the specific details.

Excellent. Now here's a question. Since you have been with Jim in a coaching session, would you say that he operates in a procedural way or is he always looking for options? Procedures, definitely. He corrected me several times in our first talk, telling me that he wasn't ready to move on to something that I inquired about. It was like he was on a

railway track and couldn't get

The "Meta" of Meta-Programs

By definition, *meta*-programs operate at a higher level, one *above* the primary level thinking-and-feeling. As such, they are related to *meta*-states. How?

> *Meta-states form the foundational structure of meta-programs.* ***Meta-programs are the result of meta-states— meta-states so habituated they have coalesced into muscle memory and are now in our eyes as perceptual lens.***

Meta-programs begin as meta-states. These perceiving patterns begin as a mind-body state made up of particular thoughts, emotions, and sets of physiologies. Eventually, we default to them so often, perhaps so intensely, perhaps because we "had to" (we were commanded to do that, or forbidden to go the opposite way), eventually they became the primary (or even only) way that our mind-body neuro-pathways go. They get into our muscles. They become neurological. In fact, some early descriptions of meta-programs called them "neurological sorts."

This understanding of how *meta-programs* arise gives us model for thinking about what happens to a meta-state in the process. As we activate the reflexivity mechanism of mind we continually bring thoughts-and-feelings to reflect back onto our thinking, we thereby construct our *state*-about-*state* structures. Reflective thinking operates at the core of the ability to make a meta-move to a higher logical level with your thoughts-and-emotions. As you reflexively think about your thoughts, this moves you up (conceptually) to ever higher levels. That's because you are layering thoughts-and-feelings onto thoughts-and-feelings.

Yet it doesn't stay layered in the way this metaphor suggests. Unlike an onion with stable layers or a set of Russian Dolls embedded in each other, *mind-emotion states are dynamic.* They are also fluid in that they keep moving. They are always in flux. As you run your neuro-pathways in a particular way (matching/ mismatching; options/ procedures; global/ specific, etc.) these ways of processing information and using your nervous system and brain habituate. These higher levels *coalesce* into the lower levels. They merge into them. Eventually, all that's left is *a perceptual frame-of-reference* richer and fuller than just a single perception. Now your representational frame is textured and qualified by a higher state or frame. Now it becomes your stabilized state, the state that you use to see the world. It is in this way that your meta-states solidify into meta-programs.

Suppose a person *over-uses* the meta-state of global thinking while at the same time he de-emphasizes detailed thinking. At the same time that this particular thinking pattern is operating, it is also a state of consciousness (a meta-state). The person is in a *global state*. The person is accessing general thoughts-and-emotions. He has stepped into a state of being a visionary, seeing the big picture, operating from a philosophical stance, etc. He is operating from the meta-program of global. If he does this regularly, then the global meta-program will come to govern his way of thinking. So, use that to pace his sense of reality.

You further solidify a meta-program when you *value* them. Also when you *believe* that they are important. You could also construct this meta-program by bringing it upon itself (global about global), *joyful* about global thinking, *fearful* to get too specific, *dislike or disgust* about details, etc. There are actually a great many ways that you could construct the meta-program using various meta-state structures. Then, when you over-use this— a habitual meta-program emerges.

Repeating any meta-state structure over and over will lead to creating a habituated meta-state, hence, meta-program. Sometimes these meta-structures become a new category—a *gestalt state*. Then it creates an entire mental context. The meta-state then becomes so pervasive that it is like living in that atmosphere which, in turn, filters everything—all incoming information and all outgoing perceptions. It also filters your understandings, experiences, memories, etc. So, meta-programs are coalesced meta-states. And the more you value, believe in, appreciate, find benefits in, and identify with the meta-state, the more you create a *driver meta-program.*[4]

> *Meta-states form the foundational structure of meta-programs. Meta-programs are the result of meta-states. They are meta-states that have become so habituated that they have coalesced into muscle and have thereby gotten into our eyes as our perceptual lens.*

A *driver* meta-program means that the state and its "program" for how to think, perceive, and attend information becomes your default style. It becomes your "way of being" in the world. This means that it operates as your particular way of *doing* your "personality." After all, **personality** is not a "thing," but a set of processes that you *do.* This keeps the action and process within the concept front and center making it more fluid and easy to transform.

In a *driver* meta-program we have our primary states embedded inside of a larger context that is made up of the meta-states that form the meta-program. Consider when the meta-program of mis-matching is a driver. Here the cognitive style of perceiving, attending to what is different, is embedded inside of some higher states. The person undoubtedly *believes* that doing this is important and valuable. It's a way to "be oneself," to "think one's own thoughts," to "not be controlled," to "not be told what to do or think," etc. It could also be embedded in other higher frames: This is who I am; I have to do this; memories of parents or teachers forcing me to do things their way shows what happens when you just give in and compromise, etc.

Modeling any particular person who is highly driven for *mis-matching,* however, will provide different structures for a given gestalt. Yet the basic principle is that within every meta-program there are layered meta-states within even higher meta-states that support, validate, and give the meaning structure. In Meta-States there are always "frames by implication." Whatever state you apply to another state, and so layer mind level upon level, there are multiple implied frames that you have not made explicit. You have assume them.

So while meta-states and meta-programs are *fluid dynamic structures hidden behind* everyday experiences, they are always leaking out and showing up in a person's states. They show up in talk, actions, and gestures. They show up in skills, interests, and focus of attention. These governing structures influence how you experience yourself, others, and life. In this, meta-programs are always showing! And for those who have eyes to see and hears to hear—seeing, detecting, recognizing, and using meta-programs becomes a highly refined skill that enriches everything about communicating and relating.

Summary

Welcome to the domain of Meta-Programs. This training will give you a highly valuable tool for modeling, profiling, understanding, communicating, coaching, training, and much, much more. As a model, it offers you a key structural aspect of your everyday experiences and states.

Meta-programs are not genetic or unchangeable. They arise as meta-states and when they become solidified meta-states, they "get into your eyes." Now they are *meta-programs.* And although habitual, they are changeable. Recognizing meta-programs offers you a way to increase your ability to persuade others.

Notes:

1. We identified 51 meta-programs in the 1997 edition of *Figuring Out People.* In the second edition (2005), we added some, rearranged others. Now there are 60.
2. This line is a mind-line— a line that changes minds by reframing the meaning.
3. The meta-stating process involves creating a meta-relationship between the component elements of our states (our thoughts, emotions, and sets of physiology). When we put one in a meta-position to another, it becomes a meta-stating frame and so embed the previous in the higher. See *Meta-States* (2000).
4. See *The Structure of Personality: Modeling Personality using NLP and Neuro-Semantics* (2001).

THE MAGIC OF META-PROGRAMS

There is *magic* in knowing, detecting, pacing, and using meta-programs. This is the magic of seeing the hidden structure in a person's frames. It is the magic of being able to respond to that structure and to work with these hidden processes. It is the magic of obtaining *insider knowledge* of ourselves and others. When we can do that, then we can also experience the magic of being able to enter into another person's matrix of frames with ease and grace.[1]

Because meta-programs describe one of the hidden processes or dynamic structures in how we attend things, focus our perceptions, *and filter the lenses of our mental sight—detecting, recognizing, and using meta-programs offers a yellow-brick road into human reality*. Otherwise, people seem mysterious, strange, weird, unfathomable, and stubborn. Knowing how to work with meta-programs enables us to create rapport at a higher or meta level, and to gain trust and credibility with more elegance and speed.

The Magic is in the Structure

While it may sound strange at first, *it is structure that puts into our hands the power of what we would otherwise call "magic."*

> It is knowing and being able to work with the *structure* of electricity that enables us to command its power. It is the ability to recognize the structural form and processes of aerodynamics, physics, language, and a thousand other things that actually empowers us to take charge of these domains and put the principles of structure to new usages.

In terms of meta-programs, recognizing the inner hidden processes and dynamic structures behind our perceptual styles is what enables you to recognize them for what they are and to pace them.

> When I recognize that the person who makes life a living hell for me is just using the *mis-matching* meta-program, I can stop personalizing the problem and demonizing the person. Then I can even work with the mis-matching in a way that takes the bite out of it. I can ask and invite, even command, the person to mis-match and enjoy the person in spite of his or her verbal behavior.

Any meta-program that a person uses in a wrong context will work against the person or against being able to achieve some objective. When that happens it becomes unecological. The "magic" of transformation occurs when someone recognizes the structure involved and hones in on that leverage point of change. It is also the very flexibility of consciousness between the poles on any meta-program continuum that creates the magic of wholeness. By synthesizing both sides, you are empowered so that you can take your performances to the next level.

Why bother with so many meta-programs? Why an entire encyclopedia of meta-programs? Mostly because in different contexts, professions, domains whether it be coaching, therapy, management, intimate relationships, modeling, sports, wealth building, leadership, etc. *different perceptual filters will be needed.*

The traditional NLP list of 14 meta-programs is a great beginning. Yet it is inadequate for many of the other hidden structures that govern thinking in specific contexts. That's why the 60 in this training.

Any thinking pattern as a structured way of thinking or perceiving can become a meta-program. All a person has to do is *think that way* long enough and it will become a meta-program. As we reflexively bring that kind of awareness to ourselves, it will become our perceptual filter.

> Take the childish thinking of entitlement ("It's mine; you owe me; I deserve whatever I want."), repeat that often enough and eventually even that could become a person's meta-program. Do you know anyone who walks through life with that way of perceiving things? That's the under-responsible meta-program.

Modeling Distinctions

For every modeler the ability to detect such patterns of thinking and perceiving, hence meta-programs, must extend beyond the first 15 or so. Who knows what new and dynamic meta-programs will be discovered in the coming years that will accelerate learning and skill development in various areas? Who knows what new meta-program thinking/ perceiving patterns will facilitate our development of expertise and excellence beyond today's experts? What's been considered "magic" in those experts may be the special meta-programs that they meta-stated to their way of seeing the world.

Meaning, Meaning-Making and Meta-Programs

Meaning itself is a very special "magical" kind of phenomenon. What is "meaning?" The word suggests that it is whatever you "hold in mind." So how and what do you "hold in mind?" It is *not* the ever-changing movies that play across the screen of the mind. Primary state images and sounds come and go.[3] They come and go depending on what you are seeing, hearing, and feeling in the external world and what you use to recall them.

What you "hold in mind" are all of your meta-level understandings, beliefs, values, decisions, intentions, etc. You meta-state these mental phenomena into the frames of your mind and so create your matrix.[*4] You construct meaning via the levels of meaning-making that you invent as you build up your "model of the world."

You not only "hold in mind" various representations, you use your own style in the way you edit them with cinematic features (e.g., "sub-modalities"). You also "hold these in mind" as you classify them, categorize them, build understandings, generalizations, beliefs, etc. about them. This creates the frames-embedded-in-frames structure of your model of the world which makes up your meanings.

What does anything *mean* to a person? It depends on how the person represents it, cinematically encodes the representations, classifies it, evaluates it, associates emotions to it, metaphors it, etc. These are some of the levels of meaning in your

Meaning Matrix.[1] Also, there are all of the thinking/perception patterns (or meta-programs) that you use to create meaning. This understanding now enables you to see how meta-programs make up part of your Meaning Matrix and why shifting a meta-program can sometimes have magic-like effects on the whole system.

Example

Recently in presenting some matrix skills at a training around the subject of wealth creation so that participants could develop their own Wealth Matrix, Larry said that he loved all of the information, but felt stuck. How did he feel stuck? He didn't like the details. "Too many details," he told me.

> "I'm a global person. I get the big idea. I see the vision and then I just hire people to do the details for me."

"So does that mean you are stuck in the global meta-program and cannot *detail down* to the specific actions, processes, and distinctions? Is that what you mean?"

> "Well, I wouldn't put it that way. I don't like the idea of being 'stuck' in being Global."

"When you see a great opportunity, do you never need to be more specific about how, when, who, which, where, and all of the other indexing of specifics?"

> "Well, no. Sometimes I do find it really hard to even explain myself when I'm trying to get someone else to do a job."

"Sounds like you're stuck at the general or global level and that you don't have the resource, skills, or freedom to 'meta-detail' the specifics to actualize the opportunity. How does it feel to realize that?"

> "I don't like that at all."

"Would you like to change it so that you at least have the option of meta-detailing when you want to?"

> "Sure."

It was at that point that I began working with Larry as I coached him through the process for changing meta-programs. Fifteen minutes later he felt a new level of freedom and choice and power that he had never had before. He felt rich inside about translating the opportunities that he could *see* into opportunities that he could actually *seize* in action. At that moment, he felt that something magical had happened. That's the magic of shifting the way we construct meaning and the perceptual filters we use in our engagement with reality. And when we change meaning, we change the semantic meanings that get into our body, freeing or limiting us.[*5]

Summary

There is "magic" in knowing, detecting, and using meta-programs in a conscious and mindful way. The magic is in the structure and in knowing how to work with that dynamic structure. It will give you insider knowledge that you can use to communicate, relate, and persuade more effectively. The list of meta-programs

is a good beginning, but limiting for modeling excellence. In this we need a more extensive list to cover the many other options that experts use in the thinking and perceiving that creates their expertise. Meta-Programs describes one of the ways that we create meaning within our mind-body-emotion system—and how we hold meaning in our mind.

Notes:

1. The word "matrix" refers to a womb and so refers to a place where something is given birth. In humans, our subjective experiences are given birth from and in our mental-and-emotional *frames.* The Matrix model refers to a systemic template from cognitive and developmental psychologies for understanding and working with our matrix of frames.
2. Look for the new edition of *Figuring Out People* in 2005.
3. The *movies* in our mind refers to what NLPers call the VAK (visual, auditory, kinesthetic representational systems). See *MovieMind* (2003).
4. For more about these models, see the books *The Matrix Model* (2003) and *Frame Games* (2000).
5. To learn to detect and use meta-programs, see the Meta-Program Board Game, *Meta-Detective Game.* It offers a fun way to learn and become skilled with meta-programs.

META-PROGRAM TEMPLATE

COGNITIVE Thinking	**EMOTIONAL** Feeling	CONATIVE Choosing	SEMANTIC Meta Meta-Programs
1. Representation: Visual, Auditory, Kinesthetic— Language	19. Convincer Representation: Looks right, Sounds right, Feels right — Makes Sense	34. Convincer Demonstration: Number of Times Length of Time	48. Self-Experience: Mind, Emotions, Will, Body, Roles, Dis-identified
2. Epistemological: Sensor — Intuitor Experiencing, Modeling Conceptualizing	20. Movie Position: Inside — Outside Stepping in— Stepping Out Associated feeling — Dissociated thinking	35. Motivation Direction: Toward— Away From Approach—Avoidance Attractions— Aversions	49. Self-Instruction: Compliant—Strong-Will Balanced
3. Scope: General global— Detail specifics Inductive — Deductive	21. Exuberance: Desurgency — Surgency Timid — Bold	36. Organization Style: Options — Procedures Alternatives — Sequential	50. Self-Confidence: Low — High Inbetween
4. Relationship Comparison Matching Sameness — Mismatching Difference Stability — Change	22. Stress Coping: Passive, Assertive, Aggressive	37. Adaptation: Judging — Perceiving Controlling — Releasing	51. Self-Esteem: Conditional — Unconditional
5. Information Staging: Foregrounding & Counting Backgrounding and Discounting	23. Authority Source: Internal –- External	38. Modus Operandi: Necessity, Desire Possibility, Choice Impossibility	52. Self-Integrity: Conflicted — Incongruity Congruent — Integrated
6. Scenario Type: Pessimistic — Optimistic Worst — Best Case Scarcity — Abundance	24. Attention: Self — Other	39. Preference: People, Place, Things, Activity, Information	53. Responsibility: Under-R. — Over-R. Healthy Responsibility
7. Classification Scale: Black-white, Either-Or — Continuum — Multi-Dimensionality 8. Nature: Static — Process Aristotelian— Non-A.	25. Em. Containment: Uni-directional— Multi-directional	40. Goal Striving: Skeptic/ Perfectionism Vs. Optimization	54. Ego Strength: Unstable and weak — Strong and Stable

9. Focus: Screening— Non-Screening	26. Rejuvenation: Introvert — Extrovert Ambivert	41. Buying: Cost, Quality, Time	55. Morality: Overly strong super-ego Strong super-ego Weak super-ego
10. Philosophical: Why (Origins)— How (Solutions) Understanding—Getting Results	27. Somatic Response: Reflective , Active Reflective, Inactive	42. Social Convincer: Distrusting Suspicious— Trusting Naive	56. Self-Monitoring: Low external—High Internal
11 . Communication: Verbal — Non-Verbal Digital — Analogue	28. Social Presentation: Shrewdly Artful— Artlessly Genuine	43. Interactive: Competitive—Cooperative Win/Lose — Win/Win	57. Time Zones: Past, Present, Future
12. Durability: Permeable — Impermeable	29. Dominance: Power, Achievement, Affiliation	44. Directness: Inferential — Direct High— Low Context	58. Time Experience: In Time — Through Time Random — Sequential
13. Causation: Causeless, Linear, Complex, Personal, External, Magical, Correlation	30. Work Style: Independent, Team Player, Manager, Bureaucrat, Follower	45. Management: Control, Delegate, Collaborative Flexibility	59. Quality of Life: Be — Do — Have
14. Completion: Closure — Non-Closure	31. Change Adaptor: Closed — Open Late—Medium— Early	46. Risk Taking: Aversive — Embracer Fearful — Excitement	60. Values: List of Values Nominalizations of what we believe as important
15. Information Kind: Quantitative— Qualitative 16. Stream of Conscious. Focused — Diffused In-between 17. Conventional: Conformist — Non-Conformist 18. Speed: Deliberate and Slow Witty and Quick	32. Attitude: Serious — Playful	47. Decision Making: Cautious — Bold	

UNDERSTANDING META-PROGRAMS

What they Are? Where they Come From? What is their value?

What are Meta-Programs?

_____

_____

_____

Who originated the first discovery of the NLP Meta-Programs?

Meta-programs arose when Leslie Cameron Bandler discovered that while doing classic NLP, many of the patterns did not always work. She and Richard used that as an opportunity to discover *why not.* The result were the first meta-programs. Meta-programs enable us to know when, how, and why NLP patterns work when they do and when they don't and what to do.

What are the sources of our meta-programs?

They arise from both nature and nurture — from natural dispositions and tendencies and from learning experiences. Meta-Programs, as we experience them, also arise from the solidification of meta-states. They begin as a learned, taught, and/or coached way to think, sort, perceive, etc., and eventually become our *mental program* for such. As solidified meta-states, they are *ways of thinking and conceptualizing* that have gotten "in our eyes" (meta-states coalesced into our muscles).

Can we put meta-programs on a continuum?

Yes indeed. Most of the meta-programs operate on a continuum. When there are choices on either end or pole this can lead to extreme versions of the particular meta-program and the creation of a *driver* meta-programs. When a person can easily move back and forth along the continuum, they have a high degree of *flexibility of consciousness*. This gives them more choices and power of response in different contexts.

Aren't meta-programs context dependent?

Yes, definitely! Meta-programs shift and change depending on the context. This gives us the ability to operate with different meta-programs in different contexts, environments, situations, etc. This also explains why MP should not be used or confused with "personality traits" that define what a person "is." These are not written

> **"Meta-Programs"** are those *programs* in our eyes or minds by which we filter what we see in the world. As perceptual filters, our meta-programs identify what we sort for, pay attention to, look for, "see," etc.

in stone. They are descriptions of how we behave... mentally and perceptually to the world. They are descriptions of how we have learned to sort and process information. Rather than solidified personal "traits' these are ways of functioning, ways of "running our brain."

Can we change and/or expand meta-programs?

Can you change your meta-programs? Yes, you bet! Meta-programs are changeable. The degree of changeability, on the other hand, depends on several factors: our beliefs about changing them, our desire and motivation, our willingness to give change processes a chance, the skill of the person working with us, the patterns used in bringing about a change, etc. Any and every meta-program can be changed when there's a desire and a skilled practitioner.

Are meta-programs "things" or are they processes?

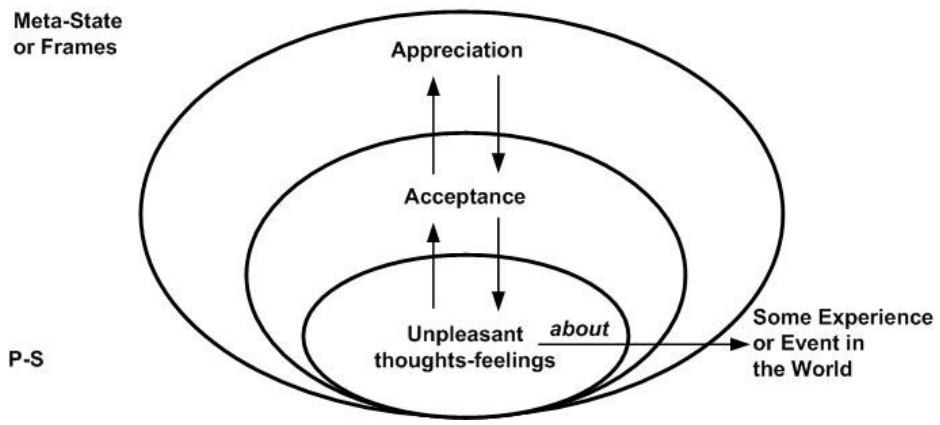
Meta-programs refers to something we *do*, not what we are. It's how we see the world and the processes involved in seeing and orienting ourselves to see the world in a certain way.

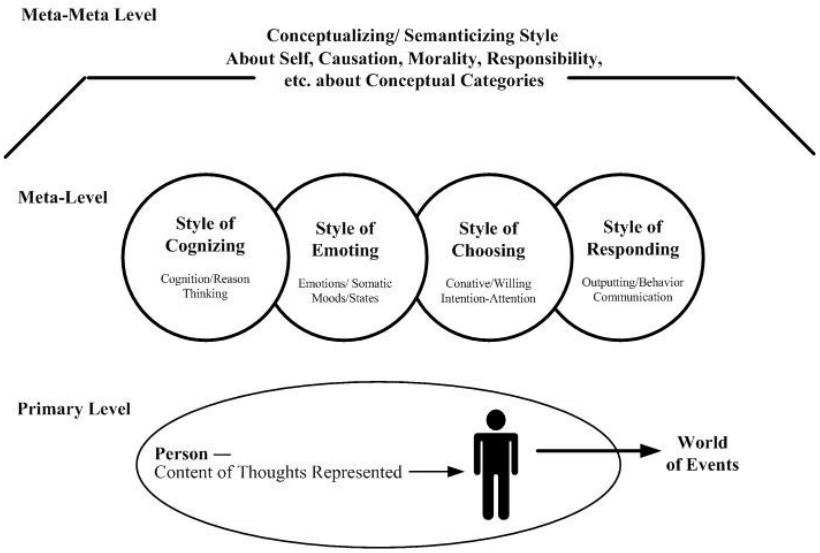
Can we use meta-programs to profile people and experiences?

Yes! Meta-programs are valuable for picking the right people, reading people, They offer us a way to find the leverage point for change.

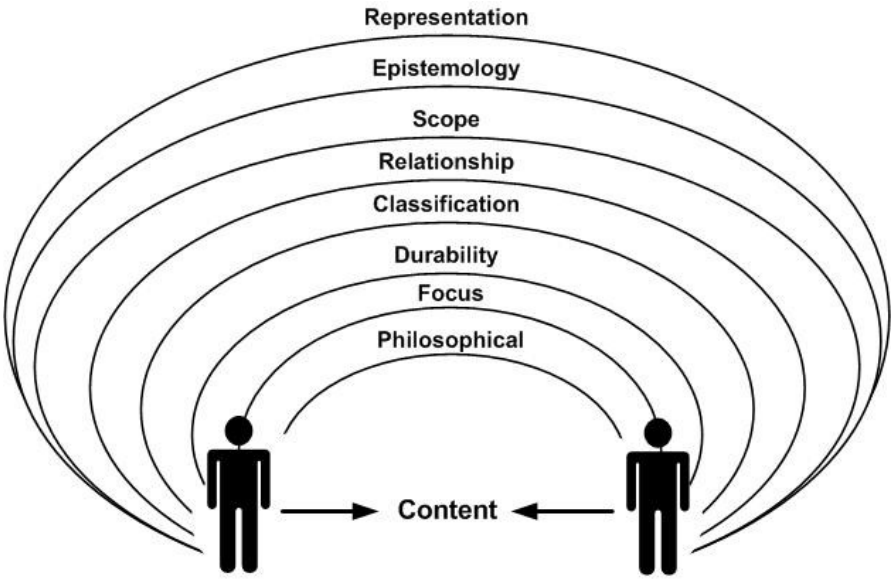
What are the meta-levels of meta-programs?

Because meta-programs operate at a meta-level to the content of thought-emotion, and awareness — we have to take a meta-position to the *primary state* wherein the content occurs. As we do, we can then utilize the traditional *categorizes* of consciousness (cognition, emotion, choosing, etc.) to make here level meta-distinctions. This leads to the following:



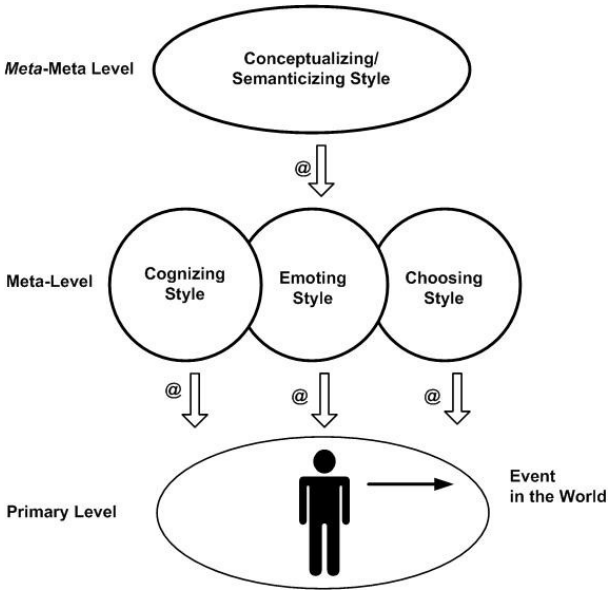


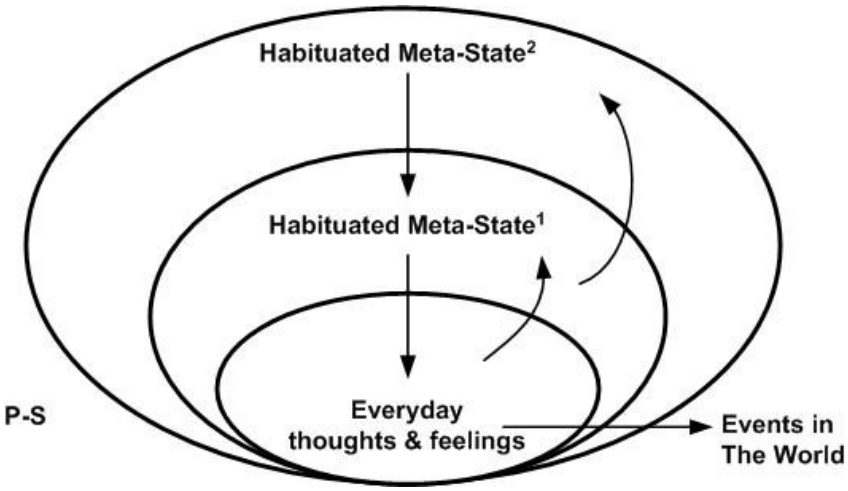
In this, we *meta-state* our meta-program filters into existence. By meta-stating, we set higher frames for perceiving and these eventually coalesce and get into our eyes. This gives us *levels* of thought. The various concepts that we meta-state as frames that become meta-programs.



How are meta-states and meta-programs related?

We meta-state thoughts and feelings to create frames, frames of mind. These habituate and as they do, they form our meta-programs. This makes meta-programs solidified meta-states. The meta-levels of our meta-programs. This was our first structure in figuring out people.





The Cognitive or Thinking Meta-Programs

#1. Representational:
Visual, Auditory, Kinesthetic, Language
#2. Epistemological:
Sensors—Intuitors; Experiencing, Modeling, Conceptualizing
#3. Scope:
General Global — Detail Specifics
#4. Relationship Comparison:
Matching Sameness — Mismatching Differences
#5. Information Staging:
Foregrounding or Counting — Backgrounding or Discounting
#6. Scenario Type:
Pessimist — Optimist; Worst — Best Case; Scarcity —Abundance
#7. Classification Scale:
Black-and-white — Continuum — Multi-Dimensionality
#8. Nature:
Aristotelian and Static — Non-Aristotelian and Process
#9. Focus: *Screening — Non-screening*
#10. Philosophical:
Why (Origins) — How (Solution)
#11. Communication Channel:
Verbal — Non-Verbal
#12. Durability Sort:
Permeable — Impermeable
#13. Causation:
Causeless, Linear, Complex, Personal, External, Magical, Correlational
#14. Completion:
Closure — Non-Closure
#15. Information Kind:
Quantitative — Qualitative
#16. Stream of Consciousness:
Focused — Diffused
#17. Conventional:
Conformist — Non-Conformist
#18. Speed:
Deliberate (Slow) — Witty (Fast)

The Emotional or Feeling Meta-Programs

#19. Convincer Representation:
Looks, Sounds, or Feels Right — Makes Sense
#20. Movie Position:
Associated feelings — Dissociated thinking; Step in — Step out
#21. Exuberance:
Desurgency — Surgency
#22. Stress Coping:

Passive, Assertive, Aggression

#23. Authority:

Internal — External

#24. Attention:

Self — Other

#25. Emotional Containment:

Uni-directional — Multi-directional

#26. Rejuvenation:

Introvert — Extrovert

#27. Somatic Response:

Reflective, Active, Inactive

#28. Social Presentation:

Shrewdly artful — Artlessly genuine

#29. Dominance:

Power, Achievement, Affiliation

#30. Work Style:

Independent, Team player, Manager, Bureaucrat

#31. Change Adaptor:

Closed — Open; Late—Medium— Early

#32. Attitude:

Serious — Playful

#33. Persistence:

Impatient — Patient

The Conative or Choosing Meta-Programs

#34. Convincer Demonstration:

Number of times

Length of time

#35. Motivation Direction:

Toward — Away From; Approach — Avoidance

#36. Operational Style:

Options — Procedures

#37. Adaptation:

Judging — Perceiving

#38. Modus Operandi:

Necessity, Possibility, Desire, Possibility, Impossibility

#39. Preference:

People, Place, Things, Activity, Information

#40. Goal Striving:

Skeptic, Optimization, Perfectionism

#41. Buying:

Cost, Quality, Time

#42. Social Convincer:

Distrusting — Trusting

#43. Interactive:

Competitive — Cooperative

Win/Lose — Win/Win

#44. Directness:

Inferential — Direct

High — Low Context

#45. Management:

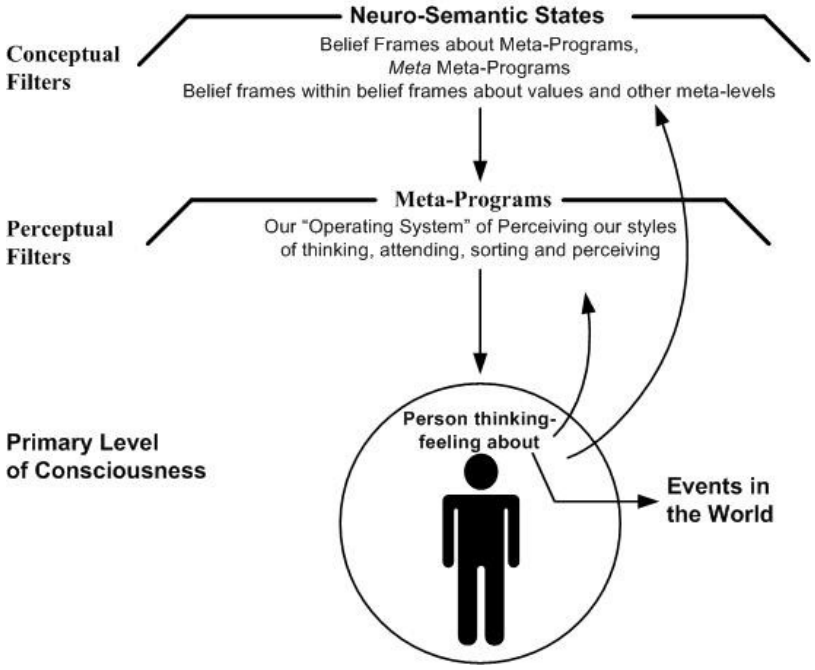
Control — Delegate — Collaborative

#46. Risk Taking:

Aversive — Embracer

#47. Decision Making:

Cautious — Bold



The Semantic or Higher Conceptual Meta-Programs:

#48. Self-Experience:
Mind, Emotions, Choices, Body, Dis-Identified, Spirit
#49. Self-Instruction:
Compliant — Strong-Will — Balanced
#50. Self-Confidence:
Low — High; In Between
#51. Self-Esteem:
Conditional — Unconditional
#52. Self-Integrity:
Conflicted incongruity — Harmonous integrated
#53. Responsibility:
Under — Healthy Respons. — Over Responsible
#54. Ego Strength:
Unstably Weak — Strong
#55. Morality:
Overly Strong Super-Ego, Strong, Weak
#56. Self-Monitoring:
Low, External — High; Internal
#57. Time Zones:
Past, Present, Future
#58. Time Experience:
In Time Random — Through Time Sequential
#59. Quality of life:
Be — Do — Have
#60. Values:
What we Count as Important

THE MENTAL META-PROGRAMS

#1. Representational:
Visual, Auditory, Kinesthetic, Language

Elicitation:

- When you think about something or learn something new, which sensory system do you prefer?
- In thinking about things, do you prefer to do so visually, auditorially, kinesthetically, or using words?
- What kind of predicates do you tend to prefer?

Language

Visual Auditory Kinesthetic

Visual refers to seeing pictures, entertaining an internal movie, etc.
Auditory refers to hearing sounds, tones, volumes, pitches, talking to self, etc.
Kinesthetic refers to body sensations, motor responses, and leads to experiential learning, needing to get a feel for something, get one's hands on it, etc.
Language (auditory digital) refers to the linguistic and symbolic systems: math, music, abstractions, etc.

#2. Epistemological:
Sensor — Intuitor

This refers to where we tend to look for the source of the information that we process— outside in the external world or internal to our internal processing.

Sensors tend to prefer to operate with their see-hear-feel senses and so to operate in an Uptime mode of sensory awareness. They get information in see-hear-feel ways. This gives them a preference for empirical data, details, etc.

Intuitors tend to prefer to operate with their meanings (their beliefs, values, experiences, history, skills, gut feelings, etc.) And so tend to operate from the Downtime state .. that is, inside in their "in-tuiting" (in-knowings). This gives them a preference for feelings, guesses, hunches, etc.

Elicitation:

- When you listen to a speech or conversation, do you tend to hear the specific sensory-based data or do you go inside (downtime) and listen for what the speaker means?
- Do you want to hear proof and evidence from the outside or do you take more interest in your internal thoughts about it?

Sensory — Uptime	Downtime — Intuiting
Getting see-hear-feel information	Using inner meanings to understand things

#3. Scope:

General Global — Detail Specifics

Deductive, Inductive, Abductive

These terms refer to the size of the "chunks" (computer programming language) of information that we need in order to understanding something. *Chunk size* can range from very small details to very large general understandings. On a scale from Specificity to Generality, people think in terms of the small supporting details and specifics that make something up to the big picture, globally, looking for the gestalt. This leads to Inductive thinking (moving up the scale) to Deductive thinking (moving down the scale).

- What size of information do you tend to prefer when you are learning, discovering, or seeking to understand something?
- What direction of reasoning do you feel most comfortable with? Inductive or Deductive?
- What do you want first when you hear something new, the big picture or the details?

Inductive	Abductive	Deductive
Reasoning from details up to higher or more abstract principles	Reasoning "to the side" and thinking in metaphors	Reasoning or thinking by moving down to specific details

Levels of Thought & Language

High Level Abstractions ↑ ↓	We move up using hypnotic language.
What does that meaning mean to you? *What idea, example describes this?"* *For what purpose...?* *What intention do you have in this...?*	We move up the scale by asking about meaning and significance... by asking about various meta-levels: decisions, identifications, intentions, outcomes, etc.

What does this mean to you?	When we move up, we get into the higher Meta-Model distinctions: nominalizations, Complex Equivalences, Cause-Effects, Presuppositions, etc.
↑ ↓	When we move Up & Down we elicit
What are some examples of this?	*the Structures of Intuition.*
What are some referent experiences?	Deductive Intuition involves taking a
What do you mean specifically?	general principle & applying or relating it
When? Where? Who? In what way?	to specific situations.
The Smallest Details	Inductive Intuition involves taking lots of details and generalizing upward to new conclusions, meanings, & connections.

#4. Relationship Comparison:

Matching Sameness — Mis-matching Differences

Sameness Or matching seeks to understand how something *matches* or fits with what one already knows. This may come out of and may lead to the state of wanting things to remain pretty much the same, to keep the status quo, to maintain the routine, to avoid change, etc. "Being the same, in common, similar, not changed."

Difference or mismatching seeks to understand something in terms of how it differs from what one already knows. This may come from and may lead to the states of wanting change, enjoying it, seeking it, resisting sameness, routine, etc. "Different, new, change, switch, transform, unique."

- What is the relationship between X and Y?
- How do you compare X and Y?
- How do you go about understand something new? Do you look first for similarities and match up the new with what you already know? Or do you first check out the differences? Or do you first do one pattern and then immediately do the other?

Matching	matching	balanced	mis-matching	Mis-matching
Sameness	with exceptions	Equally	with exceptions	Differences

#5. Information Staging:
Fore-grounding — Back-grounding
Counting — Discounting

In *representing* sensory information we create objects and characters on the theater of the mind when things go well, when there's a small success. This presupposes that we put these things somewhere on the *stage* in our mind, front and center, off to the right or left, in the background. Where do you typically *stage* good news? Where in the theater do you put things that are salient to you, that stand out, that count, and those that do not?

What and how we foreground and background things determines what we focus on, what we see, what we respond to, and essentially what counts for us. What counts for us in terms of importance, significance, and things to pay attention to are in the foreground. When we zoom in on these things, we notice. We make them front and center. What's in the background gets less attention and focus, yet sets the context, the environment, and all of the assumed and presupposed frames that contribute to the meaning and sense of what's foregrounded.

Elicitation:
- What's in the foreground of your mind?
- As you process information, do you focus on what counts and counting them?
- Or do you background those things and don't let them count?

Fore-grounding	Back-grounding
Counting	Discounting

#6. Direction:
Pessimistic — Optimistic; Worse — Best Case

Best vs. Worst Scenario Thinking: Optimists/ Pessimists — Helpless/ Empowered.

Concept: Do you look for problems, dangers, difficulties or for solutions, opportunities, etc.?

Attribution style: Seligman (1975, 1990): Learned helplessness; learned optimism

Worse Case	Best Case
Pessimistic	Optimistic
Helpless/ Deterministic	Empowered
Personal	Impersonal
Pervasive	Indexed to Where, What
Permanent	Indexed to When

Elicitation:

- When you encounter a problem, hurt, or difficulty, do you first consider the worst case scenario or the best?
- Does your mind go to problems and difficulties or to opportunities and positive challenges?
- Do you see the glass half-empty or half-full?
- Do you think that negative and bad events make you negative?
- What do you believe is most important to notice or focus on?

Pessimism / pessimists	Optimism/ optimists
Looking for what doesn't work	Looking for what's working
and involves problems and pains	and what's offering oppotunities

#7. Classification Scale:
Black-and-white — Continuum — Multi-Dimensionality

Elicitation:

- What kind of categories do you typically discern, the broad black-and-white categories or the more relative and refined steps and stages of the gray area in-between?
- Which do you value most, clearly defined categories or degrees of comparison?
- How easily can you move from black-and-white thinking to discern degrees?
- When you experience emotional states like anger, fear, joy, relaxed, love, are these either-or experiences, or matters of degree?

Black-and-white thinking	Continuum Thinking	Multi-Dimensionality
Thinking is either-or categories		Thinking in terms of multiple dimensions
	Thinking in terms of degree	

#8. Nature:
Aristotelian (Linear, Static) versus Non-Aristotelian (Process, Systemic)

Concept: How we think about external reality itself.

istotelian: Sorts in terms of things being static, permanent, solid at the micro-level. World of objects, things, people. Nouns, Nominalizations, Use of "to be" verbs, Identifications.

Non-Aristotelian: Sorts in terms of process, movement, change, flux, movement, non-things, non-linear reasoning, systems.

Elicitation:

- Do you think about things as permanent and solid or as ever-changing processes?

- Do we see things, people, activities, and processes as static or dynamic?
- Is the world made up of concrete things or ongoing ever-changing processes?
- How do we think about the territory of out there?
- Is it de up of permanent things that are solid and eternal or changing processes?

Aristotelian thinking	Non-Aristotelian Thinking
and perceiving: world is	and perceiving: world is in process,
solid, permanent, stable	fluid, always changing
Linear thinking	Systemic and non-linear Thinking

#9. Focus:
Screening — Non-screening

Concept: stimulus screening refers to how much of the environment we bring in and/or keep out.

Non-Screeners: highly distracted by the environment and stimuli around. Less selectivity in focusing, more arousal to distractions.

Screeners: more focused, easier time concentrating, less distracted. Can become inattentive, zoned-out.

Screening out stimuli	Not Screening out stimuli
Focusing and experiencing	Distracted by noises, lights,
the world "going away"	stray thoughts, voices, etc.

#10. Philosophical:
Why (Origins) — How and What (Solution)

Concept: relates to how our minds think in terms of philosophy. Do we care more about source, origins, and "why?" Or, do we care more about solution, process, and "how" to get on with things?

"Why?" Sort for the past, source of things, origins, explanations. The *why* of explanations and the *why* of origin or history. Not *why* of value (#35).

How? Sort for use, purpose, what's practical and pragmatic.

Elicitation:

- When you think about a subject (whether a problem or not), do you first think about causation, source, and origins (why), or do you think about use, function, direction, destiny (how)?
- Which do you find most interesting and compelling, the why or the how?
- Do you lean toward philosophy or practicality in your basic disposition?

Philosophically	Practicality
Why?	What and How?

#11. Communication Channel:
Verbals – Non-Verbals

Concept: We have two primary channels, dimensions, modalities for sending/ receiving information.

Verbal & Digital: Sorts for words, language, terms, content of message.

Non-verbal & analogue: Sorts for body expressions: breathing, posture, muscle tone, gestures, eye scanning, tone and volume.

Elicitation:

- When you think about communicating with somebody, what do you typically focus on and give more importance to—what they say or how they say it?
- When you communicate, do you pay more attention to the words and phrases that you use or to your tone, tempo, volume, eye contact, etc.?
- When you hear someone say something that seems incongruent with how they express it, and you don't know which message to go with, which do you favor as the more 'real' message?

Verbal focus	Non-Verbal focus
Digital awareness	Analogue awareness

#12. Durability:
Permeable — Impermeable

Concept: what's the quality of your internal constructions? How permanent, solid, "real," firm (impermeable), or loose, weak, unreal, and permeable are they?

Permeable: difficulty in keeping an idea front & center in the mind.

Impermeable: concepts strong and stable.

- How well are you able to hold and maintain an idea or representation?

Permeable	Impermeable
Concepts unstable and easily disturbed	Ideas, beliefs, etc. are not easily disturbed

#13. Causation:
Multiple, Complex, Linear, Complex, Unknown
Personal, External, Belief, Causeless, Correlation

Multi-Cause-Effect: Almost everything is multi-causal and almost everything has multiple contributing influences.

Systemic Cause-Effect:

Linear Cause-Effect: A simplistic Stimulus-Response world that's valid in a limited number of instances. A thinking pattern of children and adolescents as they begin developing their thinking skills.

Unknown Cause-Effect: Phenomenon whose cause is not known at this time.

Pseudo-Causes:

Causeless: no causes, all is by chance, random.

Personal CE: I cause whatever happens, at cause for everything

External CE: I cause nothing, it all comes from without*, blame!*

Belief CE: Beliefs about entities & forces in the universal which cause things; superstitious beliefs (e.g., this dance causes it to rain). Many religious beliefs are about cause.

Correlation: Things which happen at the same time that do not cause.

Elicitation: Ask any question that requires a causational answer.

- Why did you choose to work at your current job?

Why is your current situation in your life?

Linear	Multiple	Complex	Systems	Unknown	
None-causes:	Causeless	External	Personal	Magical	Correlation

#14. Completion:
Closure / Non-Closure

Concept: Sorting for the fullness or lack thereof of information.

Closure: sorts for completeness, fullness of information, closure, story finished, loop ended.

Non-Closure: doesn't make this sort, nice, but not necessary. Rests easily with ambiguity, confusion, open-ended processes.

Elicitation:

- If, in the process of studying something, you have to break off your study and leave it, would you feel okay about this or would you feel it as disconcerting?
- When someone begins a story without completing it, how do you feel?

Closure	Non-Closure
Dislike of ambiguity and confusion	Embracing ambiguity and confusion

#15. Information Kind:
Quantitative — Qualitative

Concept: Related to how we filter as we compare things.

Quantitative: perceive things through quanta: numbers, ranks, orders, measurements, standards.

Qualitative: perceive things through quala: quality of an experience, person, or event.

Elicitation:

- How would you evaluate your work?
- How would you evaluate things in your relationship?
- How do you know the quality of your work?

Quantitative Qualitative

#16. Stream of Consciousness:
Focus — Diffused

William James, founder of American psychology, introduced the idea that our minds and inner experience is like a "stream of consciousness." Thoughts, emotions, memories, imagination, worries, excitements, etc. rush into this stream and flow along, sometimes rapidly and wildly, and sometimes gently and calmly. This metaphor enables us to think about the quality of our stream of consciousness in terms of a meta-program that gauges how focused or diffused our stream of consciousness is typically.

Elicitation:

- On the average, how focused or diffused is your awareness?
- Are you generally focused in your awareness or easily distracted by diffusing it?
- Under what conditions, if any, are you focused and concentrated in your awareness?

Focused Diffused

#17. Conventional:
Conformist — Non-Conformist

The concept in this meta-program concerns how we think about "fitting in" with others, with significant groups, and with society as a whole. What do we think about getting along, conforming, fitting in, being a part, being accepted, being liked, having approval, etc. or are these experiences not desired? How important is that? Similar to Social Presentation (#28), this meta-program focuses on our thinking—how conventional or non-conventional our thinking style and focus.

Elicitation:

- How important is fitting in with others to you?
- How much of your mental time do you spend thinking about being accepted by others?
- What social groups do you want to be a part of?
- To what extent do you dislike fitting in and enjoy being the rebel?

Conformist Balanced Non-conformist

#18. Speed:
Deliberate and Slow
Witty and Quick

This meta-program relates to the speed of our thought processes. Do we think and process information quickly or slowly? How deliberate and thoughtful are we generally and how much flexibility do we have to slow down thought or to speed up our processing? This meta-program deals with the quickness or slowness of our mental processes and our wit.

Elicitation:

- Are you a quick thinker and speaker?
- Do you typically jump to conclusions when you listen or read?
- Are you more of a slow and deliberate thinking who weighs things carefully?

Deliberate and Slow Witty and Quick

THE EMOTIONAL META-PROGRAMS

#19. Convincer Representation:
Looks, Sounds, or Feels Right — Makes Sense

This MP refers to the state of feeling convinced about something. What convinces you? How do you make your choices and decisions? Which sensory system do you use? What do you rely upon?

Visual convincer:	You have to see it, imagine it, view it. You have to see it in color, close, etc. Seeing convinces.
Auditory convincer:	You have to hear it, experience the sound qualities of it.
Kinesthetic convincer:	You have to feel it, get a sense of how it feels, experience it.
Word convincer:	You have to have the right words that properly describes it, that makes the right and appropriate reasons, arguments, you have to have verbal proof, statistics, etc.

Elicitation: Ask questions that presuppose decision-making.

Why did you decide on your present choice of car?

What helps you decide where to vacation?

As you make a decision about where to vacation, *how* do you think about such? Do you see, hear, or create feelings about it?

What lets you know that you can believe that a product feels right for you?

Makes Sense (A_d) (meta-representation)

Looks Right (V^+) Sounds Right (A^t) Feels Right (K^+)

#20. Movie Position:
Inside (Stepping in or Associating and Feeling) — Outside (Stepping out to Observe, Reflect, Think or Feel)

As we process data, we can do it in one of two ways— we can step into the pictures and story to experience it or we can step out of it and just observe it. While traditional NLP uses the terminology of associate and dissociated for these distinctions*, these are problematic terms for several reasons*. Not the least of which is that in the DSM-IV and other psychological and psychiatric literature, "dissociate" is considered a form of pathology. That's why we avoid them completely in Neuro-Semantics.

When we step into the representational information that we create, we associate into the movie. Then we think and process by experiencing the full impact of the movie emotionally. Creating an associated representation enables us to see what we would see if we stepped into the movie. Representationally we are there again. We hear as if we were there, smell, taste, and feel as if immediately present. By stepping into the picture, we entertain the thoughts of the experience and so re-experience it.

When we step out of the representational movies, we think and process data with a degree of "psychological distance" from the emotional impact of the material. Stepping out enables us to see our younger self in the picture (we represent what we remember or imagine that we looked like back then). We are no longer there. We are on the outside looking in. We are on the outside observing or witnessing, not experiencing. We now see, hear, smell, and feel representations as if they stand "over there." We have stepped outside of the image so that we can think "about" things.

Elicitation:

- Think about an event in a work situation that once gave you trouble and step back into that memory, what do you see, hear, and feel?
- What experience surrounding work would you say has given you the most pleasure or delight? How do you typically feel while at work?
- When you make a decision, do you rely more on reason and logic or personal values or something else?

Stepping in to experience	Stepping out to observe
Representing things as if inside the movie	Representing things as if up on a screen

#21. Exuberance:
Timid Desurgence — Bold Surgency

Concept: How much emotional exuberance or lack there as one emotes, especially in relation to others and to tasks.

Surgency: Experiences emotions with lots of intensity, very strongly, feels throughout body. Can lead to hysteria. Supported by frames that value emotions.

Desurgency: Experiences low level of emotional intensity; typically does not trust emotions, may not want them. Value certainty, predictability, stability. May have anti-emotion frames.

Elicitation:

- Do you naturally draw toward or away from novelty?
- Are you reluctant or excited to explore new territory and to take risks?
- Do you think of yourself as a “sensitive person” with a low threshold for excitability?

Timid, Shy	Bold, Outgoing
Desurgency	Surgency

#22. Stress Coping:
Passive, Assertive, Aggressive

This MP refers to how one's nervous system at the neurological level moves toward or away from stressors, threats, dangers, and a sense of overload. Some take such on and go at it, others instinctively move away from it. Some have nervous systems that are highly sensitive to danger and others are highly insensitive to such.

Passive or the go away Flight response MP refers to moving away from dangers, stressors, threats, etc. Those with this MP tend to use the Type-B stress response.

Aggressive or the go at Fight response MP refers to the process of moving toward, and going at, threats, dangers, and stressors. Those who use this MP tend to use the Type-A stress response.

Assertive or the mindful response MP refers to the learned response, the Type-C stress response, that arises from training in thinking and talking out stresses and deciding on fight/flight responses as appropriate.

Elicitation:

"When you feel threatened, or challenged, by some stress... do you immediately respond, on the emotional level, by wanting to get away from it or to go at it?"

Passive	Assertive	Aggressive
Type B	Type C	Type A
Go away from	Think and choose best course	Go at

#23. Authority:
Internal — External

This MP relates to your sense or locus (circle, location) of "control." Where do you posit it? Do you posit the "authority" to decide, determine action, right/wrong inside or outside of yourself?

Internal and/or external Reference MP describes the view, perspective, and orientation of one who looks outward. This MP sorts for and pays attention to the views and opinions of others, to the authorities out there.

Elicitation:

- Who do you reference and rely upon for authority?
- To what extent do you feel that the locus of control in your life is inside yourself or outside in others, in rules, in social conventions, etc.?
- How do you know that you have chosen or acted right, or that you have done, chosen the right bank (right car, etc.)?
- When it comes to decision-making, how do you go about it?
- What kind of information do you want in making decisions?
- How do you know when you've done a good job?
- How do you feel about taking charge of your own life in your finances and career?

Internal Referencing	Balanced	External Referencing
Locus of Control Within		Locus of Control Outside

#24. Attention:
Self-Referent — Other-Referent

This meta-program deals with a social/relational context and focuses primarily where your attention goes—to self or to others. Where do you invest your attention as you move through the world, taking in information, communicating, relating, taking action, etc.? Do you typically attend to yourself (Self) or to others (Other)? Do you focus your attention on what you think, feel, want, choose, and do? Or do you focus your attention primarily on what others think, feel, want, choose, and do? This emotional meta-program relates to the investment of your attention and how you emotionally see the world of others.

Elicitation:

- Where do you put most of your attention—on your own thinking and choosing or externally on circumstances, events, rules, others, etc.?
- In relationships do you find yourself primarily attending to your needs or to those of others?
- If there's a conflict of interest, do you focus on your needs or those of others?
- How easy or hard is it to attend to others? To attend to self?
- Where do you put most of your attention—on yourself or on others?
- Who do you first seek to take care of or attend to?

Self Referent	Balanced	Other Referent
Strong Boundaries		Highly Skilled at Empathy

#25. Emotional Containment:
Uni-directional — Multi-directional

Concept: Relates to the focus and diffusion of emotions; emotional style in emoting, focus and spread of emotions over experience.

Multi-Directional: Experiences emotions as spreading all over and contaminating other facets of life. Uncontained.

Uni-Directional: Experiences emotions as staying contextualized to referent object and frames.

Elicitation:

- Do your emotions often bleed over and affect some or all of your other emotional states?
- Or do your emotions stay pretty much focused on whatever it relates to?
- When you get mad at work (or home) do you take your emotions with you and displace them on others?
- How easily can you let strong negative emotions go?

Uni-directional	Multi-directional
Contained, Focused	Spreads out, Diffused

#26. Rejuvenation:
Introvert — Extrovert

Concept: How we interact with and need or avoid people when we are feeling low or discouraged.

Extrovert: perception turns outward to others, desires companionship, encouragement, support.

Introvert: perception turns inward to self, wants privacy, time by self, etc.

Ambivert: uses both in a more balanced way with a sense of choice.

Elicitation:.

- When you feel the need to re-charge your batteries, do you prefer to do it alone or with others?
- How do you rejuvenate your emotional state and get into a better state of mind? What do you like to do? Do you prefer to do this alone or with others?
- How do you emotionally see others as sources for rejuvenating yourself or opportunities to serve others and contribute?
- Do social events wear you out or recharge you?

Introvert	Ambivert	Extrovert
Recharges by Self	Balance	Recharges with Others

#27. Somatic Response:
Inactive, Reflective, Active, Reactive

This MP refers to how you *act out* your thoughts, emotions, and choices, based on your neurology.

Inactive MP style refers to a response style that generates little action. You *reflect as you* think about things, mediate upon them, delay your responding, etc. When over-done, you end up being inactive.

Active MP style refers to a response style of quickly or immediately taking action on your thoughts and feelings and doing something. When it is well-tempered, it will generate proactivity, taking initiative, etc.

Reactive MP style refers to a response style of unthinking acting, operating from a reactive, even a fight/flight sense of danger or threat.

Elicitation:

- When you come into a new situation, do you usually act quickly after sizing it up or do you do a detailed study of all the consequences before acting?

- When you come into a social situation (a group, class, team, family reunion, etc.), do you usually act quickly after sizing it up or do you engage in a detailed study of all of the consequences, and then act? How do you typically respond?

Inactive	Reflective	ActiveReactive

#28. Social Presentation:
Shrewdly Artful — Artlessly Genuine

Concept: relates to how we focus when relating to and interacting with others in a social context.

Shrewd & Artful: filters for the social impression that we make, our presentation to others, carefully manages impression, fearful of negative impressions and judgments.

Genuine & Artless: Filters for being real, not being a fake, being one's own person, saying and thinking what one truly does, dis-values judgments of others.

Artlessly Genuine	Artfully Shrewd
Doesn't care about social impressions	Manages social impressions
Socially naive	Socially sophisticated

#29. Dominance:
Power, Affiliation, Achievement

Concept: Developed by David McClelland about human interacting in work contexts and structures.

Power: sorts for the power of choosing, having control, competing, dominating; politically minded; win/lose mentality common.

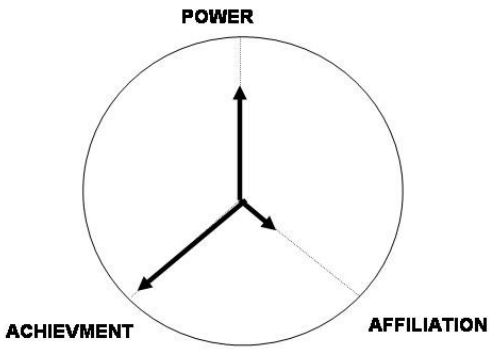
Affiliation: sorts for connection, relationship, courtesy, getting along, win/win or even lose/win. Fears conflict and criticism.

Achievement: sorts for accomplishing things, getting things done, end products.

Elicitation:

- What are your motives when interacting with others given your preferences of:
  Power (dominance, competition, politics)
  Affiliation (relationship, courtesy, cooperation) and
  Achievement (results, goals, objectives)?
- If you used 100 points as your scale and distributed the hundred points among these three styles of handling "power," how much do you give for each?
  __ Power __ Affiliation __ Achievement

Achievement	Affiliation	Power
Getting Projects Done nd Calling the Shots	Getting Along and Enjoying Each Other	Being in Charge



#30. Work Style:

Independent, Team Player, Manager, Bureaucrat

What's our preference for working, do we prefer to work alone, with others, to direct others, etc.? That's the filter that this meta-program deals with.

No-Team MP refers to preferring to work alone and assuming sole responsibility for a job or task. People who use this MP work best when in control of the part they contribute to a project. Language: I, on my own, prefer to do it myself.

Team and Self MP refers to preferring to work with others and keeping responsibility for a task in one's own hands. Those who use this MP understand working with others a hierarchy and may at times assume control and subordination to superiors. Language: I motivate people, I get others to do things.

Team MP refers to preferring to work and share responsibilities for an assignment with others and believes in the synergism of people working together. People who use this MP prefer working as a joint effort and participating with others. Language: on my own and with others, team, teamwork.

Elicitation:

- Ask the following questions successively in the following order.
  1) Do you know what you need to be more successful at work or in this task?
  2) Do you know what someone else needs to function more successfully?
  3) Do you find it easy to tell someone what they should do?
  4) Do you have a sense or vision of what else is possible in the future?

Independent	Dependent	Team Player	Manager/Leader	Bureaucrat
Self	Others only	Self and Others	Self and Others	Self

#31. Change Adaptor:

Closed — Open to Change; Late—Medium— Early Adaptors

We all have a thinking and feeling style about change. This change adaptor meta-program relates to how open or closed we are to change. Do we do so quickly and easily? Do we embrace change? Or do we fight it, resist it, fear it, hate it, and even when we want to make a change, find ourselves fighting the process of change? This meta-program is related to the meta-programs of Risk Taking (#45) and Decision Making (#46).

Everett Rodgers (1995) covers the subject of adapting innovations and posits the following adaptor distinctions:

Innovators: Venturesome	Early Adaptors: Respect
Early Majority: Deliberate	Late Majority: Skeptical
Laggards: Traditional	

Elicitation:

- How willing and open are you generally to welcoming change into your life?
- Do you tend to be a pioneer in change (a change embracer), an early adopter, adopter when the wave of change has come, a late adopter, or even a change resister?
-

Closed to Change	Open to Change
Late Adopter	Early Adopter

#32. Attitude:
Serious — Playful

Our attitude about ourselves, others, work, health, and life in general can be anywhere on a continuum from serious to fun and playful. The degree of humor in life measures how much lightness or heaviness we bring to things and filter things. As a perceptual lens, serious versus playful offers two very different ways to look at life, self, others, work, hobbies, and the world. Each meta-program filters and colors our basic philosophy about life and so relates to our Scenario Type meta-programs (#6) and our Philosophical meta-programs (#10).

Elicitation:

- Is your general attitude about yourself and others serious or humorous?
- How much humor do you generally experience about yourself when you make a mistake?
- How easily do you laugh at yourself and especially at your fallibilities?

Bland

Serious Balanced Playful

#33. Persistence:
Impatient — Patient; Reckless — Persistent

One of the factors that play a role in how we perceive, sort for things, and filter our experiences things is our degree of emotional patience or impatience. When you meta-state yourself with these emotional states, you set patience or impatience as a meta-program. With *patience* as your meta-program you develop the ability to "hang in," persist, calmly consider things, and hold the course. Without patience, mind, focus, concentration, and persistence wanes. Contexts of time pressure, social pressure, or other kinds of pressure frequently induce states of impatience thereby undermining persistence. With *impatience* as your meta-program frame you become more active, even reactive in your Somatic Response meta-program (#27).

Elicitation:

- How patient and persistent are you when you feel the pressure of a situation?
- In work and task contexts, do you look for and expect quick results or do you think patiently about the processes involved and realistically consider the time element?

Impatient with things Patient with things
Reckless, Impulsive Persistent, Reflective

THE CONATIVE META-PROGRAMS

#34. Convincer Demonstration:
Number of Times/ Length of Time

Previously we examined the meta-program of Convincer Representation (#19) which focuses on the emotional facet of being or feeling convinced. That meta-program answers the question, How does something need to be represented so that you find it so compelling that you feel convinced about it? Does it need to look right, sound right, feel right, or make sense? Being convinced, however, doesn't only involve our feelings, it also involves our choices, how we make our choices, and how we perceive the process of deciding. This brings up other factors and variables in the experience of feeling convinced: how many times it takes us to become convinced (times or repetition) and how long does it take (period of time)? James and Woodsmall (1988); Bagley and Reese (1988).

Elicitation:

- How often does someone have to demonstrate competence to you before you feel convinced?
- How many times do you typically have to see, hear, read, or do something before you feel convinced about your own competency at it?

How does your convincer (or believability) occur? Does it occur—

a) Automatically: Starts from the state of being convinced.
b) Repetition: Over a number of times: how many times?
c) Time Period: Over a period of time: how long a time?
d) Consistently: Never convinced, consistently doubting.

Automatically Number of Times Period of Time Never

#35. Motivation Direction:
Toward (Approach) —Away From (Avoidance)

Our motivational sort describes our orientation in the world in terms of how we take action and make choices of value and importance. Do we away from dangers or toward possibilities?

Away from describes the MP to think first about dangers, threats, apprehensions, etc. This typically leads a person to prefer to first make choices about safety, avoidance of problems, etc.

Toward describes the MP to think first about what a person wants, goals, dreams, outcomes, hopes, possibilities, etc. This tends to lead one to develop a moving toward values and objectives orientation in the world.

- What do you want from a relationship, or a job, etc.?
- What will having this do for you?
- What do you value of importance about...?

Values

Avoidance Approach
Moving Away From Moving Toward

#36. Operational Style:
Options — Procedures

This MP relates to your orientation style in the world, whether you move through it seeking to establish procedures, rules, and organized ways for how to do things, the right way to do things, or for whether you move through the world looking for options, choices, new ways to do things.

Procedure MP refers to seeing the world in terms of specific procedures for how to do things, and so sorts for processes, structures, organization, etc. This leads to such states as caring about finding and using the right way to do something, rules, etc.

Options MP refers to seeing the world in terms of options and choices, inventing new ways to try things, exploring alternatives, etc. This leads to such states as trailblazing, inventing, discovering, etc.

Elicitation: Ask *why* questions.

Why did you choose your car? (or job, town, bank, etc.).

Procedures	Balanced	Options
Rules, Sequences, "the right way"		Alternatives, Non-linear step

#37. Adaptation:
Judging (adapting world to you)/ Perceiving (adapting to world)

This MP refers to how we *adapt ourselves* as we move through the world. Do we use a style of navigating life by adapting ourselves to it (perceiver) or by working to make the world adapt to us (judger)?

Judger MP views the world (and so makes choices) by seeking to exercise control or management over the world. This leads to the state of taking charge, acting, innovating, being a mover and shaker, change agent, etc. Very characteristic of the Western way of life.

Perceiver MP views the world as whole and something to mostly observe, notice, and experience rather than manage or control. This leads to the states of fitting in, finding the natural rhythms of the world, being passive, enjoy the observation, being a spectator, environmentalist, etc.

Elicitation:

- Do you like to live life spontaneously as the spirit moves you or according to a plan?
- Do you find it easy or difficult to make up your mind?
- If we did a project together, would you prefer we first outline and plan it in an orderly fashion or would you prefer to just begin to move into it and flexibly adjust to things as we go?
- Do you have a daytimer-type of calendar? Do you use it? Do you enjoy using it?

Perceiving	Judging

#38. Modus Operandi:
Necessity, Possibility, Desire, Impossibility

These terms (in linguistics, *modal operators)* reflect our MO (or modus operandi) in the world, our style of operating with regard to events, tasks, people, information, etc. Do we *have to, must, should, get it, can't, can,* etc.?

Necessity MO refers to the MP of a world of shoulds, musts, have tos — necessities, rules, compulsions, laws, etc.

Desire MO refers to the world of wants, desires, hopes, get tos, etc. This invites one to live in a world of desires, dreams, goals, etc.

Impossibility MO refers to the MP of viewing the world in terms of can't, impossibilities, it won't work, etc. This invites one to live in a world of limitations, inhibitions, prohibitions, etc.

Possibility MO refers to the MP of viewing the world in terms of possibilities, cans, competencies, etc. It invites one into the world of hope and dreams.

Elicitation:

How did you motivate yourself to go to work today?

What did you say to yourself that helped to get you moving?

Impossibility	Necessity	Desire	Possibility	Choice
can't	have to, must, should	want to, desire	can	wish, will

#39. Preference:
People, Place, Things, Time, Activity, Information, Systems

We all have preferences. You have preferences about what you like and what you want to do. These show up as part of your perceptual frames when you ask about how a person prefers to do anything from taking a vacation, to working, shopping, exercising, etc. They show up also when you ask about a person's peak experiences. Asking such questions typically evokes the preference meta-programs of that person. What is your primary interest? Focus values.

Elicitation:

- What is really important to you about how you spend your next two week vacation?
- What kinds of things, people, activities, etc. would you want if it registers as a great holiday?
- Do you have a favorite restaurant? Why is it your favorite?

People	Places	Things	Activities	Information	Time	Systems
Who	Where	What	How	Why, What information	When	How interconnected

#40. Goal Striving:
Skepticism / Perfectionism — Optimization

Concept: Relates to how you adapt and respond to expectations, goals, outcomes, striving.

Perfectionism: Going for flawless perfection, focus on end-product, fearful of what could be wrong, miss the mark, never good enough. When burned-out, you become a *Defeatist / Skeptic.* You are negatively anchored to concept; refuse to set goals, refuse to compete.

Optimizing: Moving forward aiming to enjoy process and achieve aims, but taking numerous constraints into account.

Skeptic /	Perfectionism	Optimizing
Hate goal setting /	Never good enough could have done more and better	Does best one can and leaves it at that

#41. Buying:
Cost, Quality, Time

This MP refers to how you think, perceive, pay attention, and sort for when it comes to purchasing and deciding to purchase. People differ in preferring to focus on *cost, quality, and time* in different ways.

- "What do you primarily concern yourself with— the price, time, or quality, or some combination of these when you consider making a purchase?
- Put a mark on the diagram at the place that represents where you feel that you put most of your concern in the triangle. This foregrounds awareness the tradeoffs between the values.

Cost _____ Time _____ Quality

#42. Social Convincer:
Distrusting Suspicious — Trusting Naive

Concept: From how you feel convinced in general, this is how you sort for and respond to relating to others.

Distrusting — Paranoid: Immediately, automatically, and pervasively assume the worst of others, distrust: leads to jealousy, envy, guardedness, defensiveness, shallow relationships.

Trusting — Naive: immediately responds to others assuming trust, similarity, connections: leads to openness, warmth, friendliness, outgoing, can lead to being duped easily.

Elicitation:

- When you think about meeting someone new, do you immediately have a sense of trust and openness to the person, or thoughts and feelings of distrust, doubt, questions, jealousy, insecurity, etc.?
- How do you typically choose to relate to a person, or a group of people, before you know them very well? Do you do so with trust or with caution?

Distrusting	Balance	Trusting
Suspicious, paranoia setting		Takes others at their word, naive

#43. Interactive:
Competitive — Cooperative; Win/Lose — Win/Win

In interacting with people, things, information, and events we can do so in various ways according to the style and the energy expended: competitively or cooperatively in a Win/Lose attitude or in a Win/Win attitude. How do you see things? Which meta-program is the governing lens that colors this facet of life for you? Through the eyes of competition or cooperation?

Elicitation:

- When you come into a situation, how do you usually respond?
- Do you respond with a sense of cooperation or a feeling of competition?
- Is your general attitude at work one of Win/Lose or Win/Win?

Competitive	Balanced	Cooperative
Win/Lose	Depends on context and purpose of interaction	Win/Win

#44. Directness:
Inferential — Direct; High — Low Context

We all require different degrees of context in order to understand the meaning of a communication. How much context do you need? Edward Hall introduced the idea of low and high contexts in his sociological studies on communication. High and low contexts have to do with the way we explicitly assert or implicitly assume context. As such, contexting performs multiple functions. Since any shift in the level of context is a communication, whether it moves up or down it can signal a warming or cooling of relations.

> "Context is the information that surrounds an event; it is inextricably bound up with the meaning of that event. The elements that combine to produce a given meaning—events and context—are in different proportions depending on the culture. The cultures of the world can be compared on a scale from high to low context." (1990, p. 6)
>
> "A high context communication or message is one in which most of the information is already in the person, while very little is in the coded, explicit, transmitted part of the message. A low context communication is just the opposite; i.e., the mass of information is vested in the explicit code. Twins who have grown up together can and do communicate more economically (high context) than two lawyers in a courtroom during a trial (low context), a mathematician programming a computer, two politicians drafting legislation, two administrators writing a regulation." (1976)

Elicitation:

- In any given context (business, friendships, etc.), how much information do you already know and that you don't need to be made explicit?
- What do you believe and value about being direct and forthright?
- How well does assertive directness fit with your family and cultural values?

Direct	Balanced	Inferential
Low Context		High Contex

#45. Management:
Control, Delegation, Collaborative

This meta-program relates to how we perceive and make choices in working with others around experiences that have to do with managing a task, process, project, or any goal that we want to achieve. How do we go about such? Do we take control of things and just do them? Do we seek out others to delegate it to? Or do we work with others to create a joint collaboration, a mutual meeting of the minds?

Elicitation:

- When you want to or have to get something done that's important and others are involved (or could be involved), what's first on your mind—just doing it, delegating it to others, or creating a collaboration with others?
- How do you generally like to work on projects: by yourself, with others, or as a boss?

Control	Delegate	Collaborativ

#46. Risk Taking:
Fearful and Aversive — Excitement in Embracing

This meta-program addresses the subject of how do we perceive and make choices around the awareness and/or experiences of risk. How do we respond to new things, novel experiences, and/or potentially dangerous things? Do we think and feel fearful and so act with great caution, even paranoia and resistance? Or do we think and feel excited, see opportunities, and feel a rush of enthusiasm? This meta-program of choice directly flows from how we handle change and influences whether we are pioneers, first adaptors or resistors to risks.

Elicitation:

- What are your thoughts and feelings about new things, risks, and adventures?
- What are some of the biggest risks that you've taken in your personal life? In your business and career?
- Do you typically get excited or scared when it comes to facing a big risk or an unknown factor?

Aversive to Risk	Balance	The Embracing of Risk
Fearful, Suspicious, Defensive setting		Excitement, Playfulness, Hope

#47. Decision:
Cautious — Bold

When it comes to making decisions, some people seem to take forever. They weigh every facet of every pro and con and cautiously, even fearfully, go back and forth in indecision unable to decide. Eventually, circumstances force them to decide. Others are so quick about making decisions that you wonder if they ever weigh any of the advantages or disadvantages. They are decisive, and bold, and when taken to an extreme are impulsive. How do you handle decision making? Where are you in the process?

Elicitation:

- When you think about making a decision, what are your first thoughts and feelings?
- Do you like making decisions or do you find them distressful, even painful?
- When you're in a critical circumstance, how do you handle decisions?
- Do you find the process of making decisions an easy or difficult thing?
- How cautious versus bold are you in making decisions?

Cautious	Balance	Bold

THE SEMANTIC META-PROGRAMS

d#48. Self-Experience:

Mind, Emotion, Will, Body, Role/ Position, Spirit, Dis-Identified

This MP refers to the beliefs and understandings that you use and operate from in defining yourself, and so in how you *experience* yourself. You can base your self-definitions on a wide variety of your expressions or experiences:

Thought	Body	Status
Emotion	Roles	Degrees
Choice	Experiences	Etc.

Elicitation:

- As you think about your thoughts, emotions, will, body, roles, and positions that you experience in life— which facet or facets of yourself seems the most important, real, or valid?
- Do you think of yourself primarily as a thinker, emotional person, chooser, in terms of your physical looks or body, in terms of your roles and positions, or what?

Identify with — Dis-Identified

Mind Body Emotions Will Roles

#49. Self-Instruction:

Compliant — Strong-Will

This MP refers to your relationship to choice, instruction, command, authority, power, control, etc. Some people comply and others resist these experiences and so develop different MP.

Compliance MP refers to those who take orders will, who comply with instructions, who take information, demands, etc. well. They may do so in an unhealthy way (fear of taking personal responsibility, cowering before everybody else), or they may do so in a healthy way: recognition of authority structures and willingness to receive instruction.

Strong-Willed MP refers to those who either so define themselves in terms of their will and freedom of choice or those traumatized by obnoxious authority figures that they have set a frame for perceiving any instruction (even their own) as a violation of their freedom of will.

Elicitation:

- Can someone 'tell' you something? Or offer an order?
- How do you think and feel when you receive 'instructions?
- How well can you 'tell' yourself to do something and carry it out without a lot of internal resistance?

Compliant — Balanced — Strong-Willed

Easily Complies and submits to orders — Resists orders, rules, commands

#50. Self-Confidence:
Low — High Competence of Skills

This MP refers to your feelings of confidence, trust, or faith in your skills and abilities. It refers to how much faith in particular skills in a given context that you operate from. It can also refer to a generalized sense of confidence in yourself to learn, develop, grow, get it, etc.

Low Self-Confidence MP describes those who lack confidence to do a particular thing, and those who distrust their ability to learn.

High Self-Confidence MP describes those who have confidence in a particular activity, and it can refer to those who generally trust that they can learn and develop new skills.

Self-Efficacy: Based on your sense of trust in yourself to *figure things out* using your intelligence, skills, etc.

Elicitation:

- As you think about some of the things that you can do well, and that you know, without a doubt, you can do well and may even take pride in your ability to do them skillfully, make a list of those items.
- How confident do you feel about your skills in doing these things?" "How have you generalized from these specific self-confidences to your overall sense of self-confidence?

Low Confidence in skills and self High

#51. Self-Esteem:
Low conditional — High Unconditional

This MP refers to the higher level belief frames you operate from with regard to your concepts about the value and dignity of yourself, what you believe about being a human being.

Conditional Self-Esteem MP refers to viewing and feeling self-esteem as conditional and based upon any number of things as determined in a person's culture, belief-systems, etc.: looks, money, strength, intelligence, degrees, status, etc. People who prefer and use this MP are forever thinking, feeling, and concerned about how they are doing on the self-esteem scale, their ego concerns are always "on the line."

Unconditional Self-Esteem MP refers to viewing and feeling self-esteem as unconditionally given and therefore full, complete, and unassailable. People who use this MP operate have settled the question of self. "I am a somebody. I have value and worth."

Elicitation:

- Do you think of your value as a person as conditional or unconditional?
- When you esteem yourself as valuable, worthwhile, having dignity, etc. do you based it upon something you do, have, or possess, or do you base it upon a given (i.e. your inherent humanity, made in God's image and likeness, etc.)?

Low/ High Unrated ... unratable

Conditional Unconditional

#52. Self-Integrity:
Conflicted Incongruity — Harmonious Integration

How well do you live up to your values, rules, beliefs, etc.? What is your degree of integration? We are all incongruous; it is the human condition. Learning anything new and you will be incongruous for the period of time it takes you to integrate that new learning. Pseudo-integration—using low standards; pseudo-incongruity— setting perfectionistic standards.

Elicitation:

- How well or how poorly do you live up to your ideals?
- How well do you actualize your ideal self?
- Do you feel integrated, congruous, and doing well in living true to your values and visions?
- Do you feel torn, conflicted, un-integrated, or incongruous?

Conflicted Incongruity Harmonious Integration

#53. Responsibility Sort:
Over-Responsible/ Responsible / Under-Responsible

Concept: A meta MP that addresses concept of personal power/ ability to respond and to be held accountable by others.

Under-Responsible: responds with lack of acceptance of owning or wanting responsibility. Blame, entitlement, dependency, victimhood, irresponsibility.

Responsible: Appropriately balancing ownership of responses for self and to others.

Over-Responsible: takes on too much ownership, leading to care-taking, intrusion, over-involvement. This one results in an increase in stress.

Elicitation:

- When you think about having and owning responsibility for something in a work situation or personal relationship, what thoughts, memories, and emotions come to you?
- Has someone ever held you responsible for something that went wrong that felt very negative to you?
- What positive experiences can you remember about someone holding you responsible for something and/or validate you as response-able?

Under-responsibility Heathy Responsibility Over-responsibility

#54. Ego Strength:
Unstable and reactive — Stable and robust

Description: Ego-strength refers to the strength of your person to face reality for whatever is. A strong sense of self. Ego-strength enables you to do this without caving in, going in a fight or flight response (Stress Coping, #22), and being able to use your basic orientation toward external reality. Because we are born without an ego (sense of self), we are born without ego-strength—this strength of your self develops over the years through education and experience.

Elicitation:

- When you think about some difficulty arising in everyday life, a disappointment, problem, frustration that will block your progress, etc., what usually comes to your mind?
- How do you feel about such events?
- How do you typically respond to internal needs or external hardships?
- Where do your mind-and-emotions go when you face a problem?

Unstable ego-strength	Stable ego-strength
Low — weak, easily stressed	High — strong, high stress tolerance

#55. Morality:
Weak — super-ego — Overly Conscientious

This meta-program deals with how you sort for morality and ethical concepts. Some continually sort for and perceive moral issues everywhere. Others seem to operate as if there's no such thing as morality or ethics. Freud defined the super-ego as the internalized set of rules that enables you to evaluate behaviors and actions in terms of "right" and "wrong." How do you frame an activity that helps and enhances or that hurts and sabotages ourselves or another?

Elicitation:

Can you feel "bad" about some non-moral issue without turning it into guilt?
What do you think about misbehaviors that hurt and violate others?

- What do you think or feel when you discover that you acted inappropriately and violated some legitimate value that you hold or that your culture holds?
- When you think about messing up, doing something embarrassing, stupid, socially inept, etc., what thoughts-and-feelings flood your consciousness?
- How conscientious are you of following the rules and conforming to what's right?

Unconscientious	Conscientious
Low sense of morality and ethics	High sense and awareness

#56. Self-Monitoring / Self-Regulating
Low External — High Internal

Intra-personal intelligence[4] (Howard Garnder's Multiple Intelligences model) is the ability and awareness to know oneself, to turn inward and to recognize when one is experiencing emotions, desires, wants, impulses, etc. Intra-personal intelligence recognizes one's thoughts, to "go inside" and apply ideas, principles, and concepts to oneself. All of this implies the ability to monitor oneself, to take one's psychological pulse so to speak. As we differ in our ability to perceive ourselves in this way, we can view self-monitoring as a meta-program operating as one of our a perceptual filters.

Elicitation:

- What are you feeling right now? What are you thinking?
- What mental-and-emotional patterns are your strengths?
- How well do we monitor ourselves?

Low self-monitory, external — High, internal

#57. Time Zones:
Past, Present, Future

Your processing of "time" creates the time zones of your awareness of past, present, and future. Your MP relates to which time zone you prefer, pay attention to, and use as you calculate things. "Time" itself is not real and does not exist, but is a concept of comparing events. Events or activities is what we use to code the idea of "time."

Past time MP attends to the past, past events, past learnings, etc. This can lead to living in the past, to wanting the security of past references, etc. Use the past for learning, resourcing, feeling good. Don't use it to traumatize, feel bad, regret, etc.

Present time MP attends to the present, the now, and to valuing current experiences, feelings, etc. Use it to be present, to create your future, to enjoy the now.

Future time MP attends to future possibilities as you use it to create direction, vision, etc. This can lead to visionary thinking, possibilities, dreaming, or fearfully worrying about dangers and terrible things that might happen. Use for direction and inspiration (hope).

Elicitation:

- How much of your mental and emotional energy do you invest in each zone?
- How much percentage do you give to each of the time zones?
- have you developed an atemporal attitude so that you don't attend to 'time' at all?

Past — Present — Future

#58. Time Experience:
In-Time — Through-Time
Random — Sequential

How do you code your sense of historical "time" and its duration from event to event over a period of "time" creates your representational image. This typically takes the form of a "time-line" of some sort. Elicit where you put each of the time zones, then draw a line between those points. Does the line go through your body or is it outside of your body?

In-Time MP refers to processing "time" as a "line" that goes through you (through your body) so that you live and perceive "*inside of time.*" This generates an experience of living in the eternal now, and easily getting lost in time. You live in a primary state of "time" and have little awareness of "time." This makes us spontaneous and random in your orientations and behaviors.

Through-Time MP refers to processing "time" as a line that is outside of your body. Now from a higher or meta level you can see it. You are *outside* of time. It does not go through your body. This gives you more perception and awareness of "time" and makes you more sequential, linear, and "on time." etc.

In-time	Through-time
Primary time: Lost in "Time"	Meta time: Out of "Time"
Random, Eternal moment	Sequential

#59. Quality of life:
Be — Do — Have

What's your perspective about life and about living and experiencing a high quality of life? Do you have the sense (belief) that life is about being, doing, or having, or some combination of these?

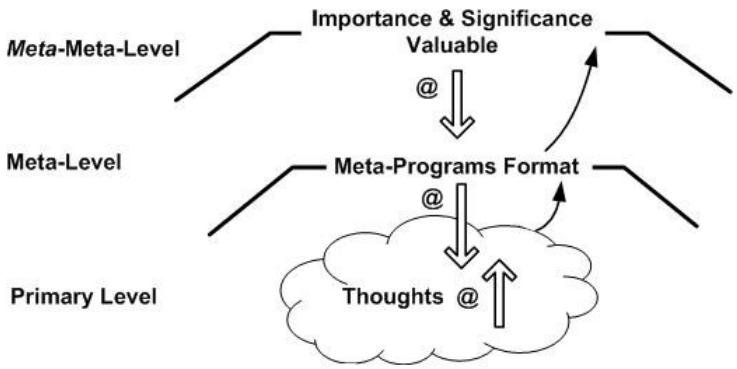
How do you perceive life and its quality in terms of being, doing, and having? To see the quality of life in terms of any of these ideas generates different lifestyles, choices, emotions, and focus. These three perspectives create different lifestyles and values.

Elicitation:

- To what extent do you think of yourself in terms of what you do, what you have, or what you experience in your being?
- What is the quality of your performance?
- What is the quality of your possession?
- What is the quality of your experience?

Doing	Having	Being

#60. Values:
What we deem Important



Because the word *value* is a nominalization, what verb hides inside that term? It is valuing. Your "values" arise from your thoughts, ideas, understandings, and emotions about *what you treat and view as important* (e.g., significant and meaningful). It is therefore via your valuation thoughts and emotions that you appraise things, people, experiences, qualities, ideas, etc. as important in living up to the standards or criteria that you want and ideas you believe in.

Values are meta-programs. "Values" as *abstractions of importance* arise when you think about "value, importance, and significance." In other words, you apply *a state* of "value" to your representations of people, places, things, events, ideas, etc. This meta-stating energizes and intensifies those representations. You then experience meta-states of appreciation, joy, concern, love, desire, etc. about these nominalized abstractions or values.

A Meta-State Question

Can we have meta-programs of meta-programs?
Can we self-reflexively apply a meta-program to itself or another?
What happens when we do?

EXPANDING META-PROGRAMS

While meta-programs seem solid and even a part of “personality,” they are subject to change. After all, we *learn* them, we *model* them from others, we *absorb* them from the homes, schools, and cultures that we grow up in.

Robbins (1986) says that one way to change a MP involves "consciously deciding to do so."

1) Become aware of the Meta-Program

2) Identify Contexts and check the ecology and value of the MP in those contexts.

3) Give permission to try it on for a day. Do you have permission to shift it?

4) Shift consciousness to the other side of the continuum and try on the other meta-programs.

5) Set multiple frames that will support using the preferred MP.

Meta-Programs inform our brain regarding *what to delete*

If we move Toward values, we delete awareness about what we move Away From.

If we sort for the Details, we delete the Big Picture.

Re-Direct awareness to what you normally delete, value that information, practice looking for it.

The Pattern (#1):

1) Identify the meta-program you want to expand or adapt.

What meta-program is currently governing your perceiving, sorting, processing, and attending that you want more choice or resourcefulness with?
Where and when, specifically, does this meta-program not serve you well?
In what contexts is it not useful?

2) Access your reason for changing it.

How does it undermines your effectiveness in those contexts?
Why do you want to change this meta-program?
What are you missing because of this meta-program?

3) Describe fully the preferred meta-program. (This tests to see how unconscious it is)

Given this meta-program is what you prefer to use in perceiving and attending, when, where, and how would you like to use this meta-program?
What is it like? How fully can you describe it?
Do you know anyone who uses this perceptual style?
What is that person's experience like? How fully can you describe it?

4) Experiment with it as you try it out.

Are you willing to imaginatively adopt the new meta-program and pretend to use it in perceiving and attending things?
How does it feel or work in some contexts where you think it would serve you better?
Does it, at first, seem a little "weird" and strange to you?
Are you willing to accept this unfamiliarity as you perceive things with this filter?
Are you willing to accept whatever discomfort arises with it?

5) Run an ecology check on this meta-program.

What is it like when you now step back from this experiment?
What do you find as you go meta to a higher level and consider what this meta-program will do to you and for you in terms of perception, valuing, believing, behaving, etc.?
What kind of a person would it make you?
What effect would it have on various aspects of your life?

6) Give yourself permission to install it for a period of time.

Would you like to try out this meta-program for a period of time?
Would you be willing to install it by granting oneself permission to use it for a period of time?
If you go inside and give yourself permission, are you fully aligned with that?
How many more times do you need to give yourself permission so that it fully settles?
Does any part of you object to it?
If yes, then take the objective into account and build a more elegant permission with it.

If no, then future pace and commission your executive mind to utilize it effectively.

For example, suppose you typically reference *others* as your meta-program and you give yourself permission to shift to *self* referencing. Yet when you do, an internal voice that sounds like your mother's voice in tone and tempo says, "It's selfish to think about yourself. Don't be so selfish, you will lose all of your friends." This voice objects on two accounts: selfishness and disapproval that leads to loneliness. Take these objections into account and rephrase your permission:

"I give myself permission to see the world referencing centrally from myself—my values, beliefs, wants, etc., knowing that my values include loving, caring, and respecting others and that this will keep me balanced by considering the effect of my choices on others."

7) Future pace the new meta-program.

What happens when you now practice, in your imagination, using this meta-program?
How much future pacing do you need to do until it begins to feel comfortable and familiar?
Do you like this?
Does it empower you and enhance the quality of your life?
Does it expand some of your skills and abilities?

Tasking for Further Development:

Do you know someone who uses this meta-program? If so then explore with that person how he or she experiences things and do so until you can take second position to it. When you can, then step into that position fully so that you can see the world out of that person's meta-program eyes, hearing what he or she hears, self-talking as he or she engages in self-dialogue, and feeling what that person feels. How is that?

The Axes of Change for Changing Meta-Programs (#6)

Finally, we can use the *Axes of Change* as a model and process for changing meta-programs. This model enables us to address and deal with the four most critical factors in change: motivation, decision, creation, and continuance. After all, we have to have sufficient *motivational energy* to change, we make a *decision* to change, we have to *create* a new game plan regarding what the change will involve and be like, and then we have to practice the change, reinforce what works well, test it out, and keep refining it so that we *sustain* the change.

To achieve this, we have designed the *Axes of Change model* to address these four mechanisms of change. This came about after researching in the field of change and after modeling how numerous people made significant changes. From that we discovered that we could map out these change distinctions using four meta-programs:

- For *motivation* the Motivation Direction meta-program, #35: *Toward* and *Away From*. This axis enables us to explore what a person wants and doesn't want, what a person wants to approach and to avoid. Working with these meta-programs both awakens vision and challenges current reality.
- For *decision* the Somatic Response meta-program, #27: *Reflective* and *Active.* This axis enables us to reflectively probe the current frames of mind in his or her matrix of meaning to facilitate weighing the pros and cons, the advantages and disadvantages of a change, and then to provide enough provocation to get the person to threshold and make the decision to "just do it." Working with these meta-programs both probes and provokes for a decision.
- For *creation* the Authority Source meta-program, #23: *Internal* and *External.* This axis enables us to reference all of the internal frames, beliefs, values, understandings, strategies, how-to knowledge, etc. to construct the new inner game and to then begin to actualize the implementation of it so that it becomes a person's outer game. Working with these meta-programs enables us to work as co-creator and actualizer with our client.
- For *solidifcation* the Relationship Comparison meta-program, #4: *Matching* and *Mis-matching.* This axis enables us to zoom in on the actual behaviors that are similar to, and match, the person's inner creation and to validate and confirm them, reinforcing what's successful. We can then focus on what's not quite up to par as we look for differences that we can then test and refine. These meta-programs enable us to positive reinforce change and test it for robustness.

The *Axis of Change* is a model of change specifically for self-actualizing change rather than therapeutic change. We designed it for *change-embracers* (Risk Taking, embracer, #46), for those seeking transformation at the level of the meta-needs rather than the lower needs, although it would also work with those *aversive* to change.[5] One last thing, because we designed *the Axis of Change* for the context of coaching, the following pattern provides a series of questions for a "coaching conversation" to facilitate a person changing a specific meta-program in a particular context.

1) Elicit sufficient motivation for the change.
Toward—

What meta-program do you want to change? Change it to what?
How would you describe the new perceptual filter that you want to take on?
What would this new meta-program allow you to do, feel, or experience?
How would it benefit your life?

Away From—

What would you no longer have to put up with?
What unpleasant or negative consequences would you no longer have to endure?
How much do you want this new meta-program?
To what extent have you had enough of the old meta-program?

2) Access a clear and intelligent decision regarding the change you want to make.

Probing and reflecting—

What are the strongest reasons for not changing?
What are the most compelling reasons to change?
How many pros and cons do you have on each side?
If you gave an emotional weight to each advantage and disadvantage from 0 to 10 and then counted up all of the advantages and disadvantages, which side carries the most weight for you?
What are the belief and value frames that currently motivated the old meta-program?
What beliefs, values, understandings, intentions, etc. that motivate changing to the new meta-program?
How long have you been trying to decide about this change?

Provoking and thresholding to a decision point—

How much longer do you want to go back and forth in indecision about this?
Perhaps you need 5 more years of the negative consequences before you're ready to act!
Are you really man enough to say yes to this change?
Do you really have the courage and commitment to make this happen?

3) Fully describe the new inner game that you'll implement and your action plan.

Co-creating and imaginatively inventing—

What's the strategy and game plan of the new meta-program?
When, where, how, in what way, why, etc.?
Do you know anyone who operates with this meta-program in a similar context?
How do they do it?
What else would make this perceptual filter richer and more compelling for you?
Have you ever viewed things in this way in another context? What was that like?
Who do you need to become in order to try on this new choice?
What would be the most empowering belief that would support this?

Actualizing and externally implementing —

What's your first action step? Your second? Third?
When will you begin? Where? What will cue you?
What's one thing that you can begin to do today that will initiate this change?

When you imagine beginning this, what's it like in your body, your breathe, your eyes?
If you were to stand up and walk with this change, what's that like?

4) Solidify the change through reinforcing and testing.

Reinforcing and celebrating small changes by matching—

How did it go yesterday? Last week?
What was the best thing in beginning to implement the change?
How did you recognize when or where to shift to the new game plan?
How well did you recognize the external cues?
How did you celebrate that in yourself?
What else can you do to celebrate that?

Testing and refining the changes by mis-matching—

What did you learn from taking these first steps?
What refinements can you make in your game plan that will make it even better?
What didn't go as well as you wanted it to?
What additional resources do you need in order to continue making this change real?

The Art of Learning Meta-Programs

1) Learn them one at a time.

An easy way to overwhelm yourself is to look at the full list of meta-programs and try to learn them *all at once.* We know several people who have attempted that to their own dismay. So we do not recommend that. Instead, aim to *learn them one at a time.* We have provided several diagrams to assist in organizing thinking and remembering them. We have also designed a sorting grid (Appendices D and E) to assist learning. Begin by using the meta-programs as a tool to make a psychological profile on yourself, and then others that you know well. This will help you think about such processing patterns. As you take the meta-programs one at a time, practice it until you feel proficient in recognizing and using it.

2) Give yourself permission to make the content/ structure distinction.

Do you have permission to step back from the *content* as you communicate, go meta and notice meta-programs? Many do not. If you do not, be sure to do that. Give yourself permission to notice both content (the story) and the form of the story. Do you have permission to go meta while you are talking with someone? Do you fear that they will see what you're doing or that it will seem rude or uncaring? If you get that kind of internal objection, then reframe it as representing a truly caring and considerate approach because it empowers you to understand them more fully.

3) Look for the pattern.

When you step back, look for the pattern. After all, if the ways we code information and pay attention to things both describe our model of the world and create it, then the ways we perceive fall into predictable patterns. This enables us to look for such systematic and regular patterns in ourselves and others. So step back and develop conscious awareness of how another is thinking and the thinking pattern that it reflects.

4) Use lots of open-ended questions.

Use open-ended questions to encourage someone to express his or her meta-programs.

> "What work experience have you found invigorating, exciting, and one of your best or even peak experiences?"
>
> "When you work, on holiday, or do a project together with others—how do you prefer to go about that?"

Using questions which invite another to indicate a typical and/or preferred way to perceive or to direct one's attention creates space for a person to use his or her meta-program style. Use the elicitation questions which we have included with each meta-program for this.

5) Use lots of downtime questions.

The best kind of open question is a downtime question. We call it "downtime"

because it invites a person to turn inward and to go down inside to find an answer. Such questions are valuable in eliciting meta-programs because they require one to actually access the required information in real time. Because we do not have information "on the tip of the tongue," there is a tendency to demonstrate the meta-program as a person accesses the information.

6) Elicit fully associated states.

To detect meta-programs, we will need to get a person into state and so *experience* the subject and not just talk about it. It is a mistake to elicit anyone's meta-programs when a person is not fully accessing an experience, but is just talking about it. The information will be less accurate and may only be the person's conscious ideas about it and not how he or she actually perceives.

7) Prioritize the meta-programs and look for the drivers.

Meta-programs do not carry the same weight of importance in any given context, but will differ according to how a person uses and values them. In *identifying* the meta-programs, *prioritize* them in terms of importance to the person in the given context. Identify the meta-programs which seem the most important and impactful. These are typically the person's favorite meta-programs or those presupposed by the experience. Keep asking yourself as you step back from the overall context, "What meta-programs seem to be exercising the most significance for this person?"

8) Practice writing pacing statements.

When you feel ready to use the information that you gather, practice writing pacing statements to match that person's processing style. This will significantly increase your communication skills and expand your flexibility.

For example, if the person strongly sorts *internally* (Authority Source meta-program, #24) and *mismatches* with counter-examples (Relationship meta-program of mismatching with polarity responses, #4), he will probably feel inclined to challenge you with "prove-it-to me" statements. This can spiral into a pointless matching of wits. Instead of going in that direction, counter that approach with a pacing statement.

> "While you are undoubtedly excellent at knowing your needs so that only you can truly decide what's ultimately right, so while here are a few ideas, you probably already know this or it doesn't really contribute to your decision."

Pacing the meta-programs which structure his thinking and emoting will fit his style and validate his values. Then, instead of fighting his style of thinking and deciding, we utilize it.

With a person who encodes things visually (Representational meta-program, #1) and thinks globally in terms of information size (Scope, #3), keep the details at a minimum and focus on describing future possibilities in general terms. This will allow the person to shape it into his or her own image. The person will also

feel respected because you are not boring her with details and so patronizing.

> "With your great eye you can see how you could use this in your business to improve production."

By learning to *match* another's meta-program patterns you avoid swimming against the current of a person's biases and processing inclinations. This puts a turbo charger to your communication skills and enriches your ability to influence. Obviously you will want to first get acquainted with your own meta-programs. This will deepen your own understanding of how you operate at this psychological level and enrich your appreciation for the value of meta-programs. Then you will know the right way to sell yourself on something you want which provides you a custom-made self-motivation program that will perfectly fit your own personality.

9) Play the Meta-Detective Game.

Finally, you can use *the Meta-Detective Game*™ to learn to detect and use meta-programs. As of 2005, this is the only Meta-Program board game available and offers a fun and playful way to learn the meta-program distinctions, how to recognize them in action, and how to use them in pacing someone to create rapport.

PRACTICE EXERCISES
FOR TRAINING YOUR INTUITIONS
TO RECOGNIZE META-PROGRAMS

Learning To Detect Patterns of Perception

If Meta-Programs, typically and mostly, operate outside of our conscious awareness, how do you bring these programs into awareness? How can you become more aware of them? How can you learn to see the effect they have on the way you process information and interact with others?

Your Self-Preparation:

1) Turn up your reasons for paying attention.

If you had a way to detect, sort out, and pay attention to these meta-level patterns. ... If you could *consciously detect and track how any given person attends the world,* you would have a way to more effectively understand and even predict that person's style of hearing and responding to things. This would give you an awareness of that person's model of reality.

2) Access your best State of Sensory Awareness

Access your Uptime state.

3) Access your best state of Flexibility

Knowing another's model of the world *and* having the flexibility to alter your own behaviors and communications empowers you to meet that person at where they are. This way of connecting and matching creates *rapport* which reduces resistance, conflict, and misunderstandings.

What to do as You Practice:

(1) Assist the person into a more fully associated state.

The more one is in an experience, the cleaner the information we'll gather. Amplify that state when necessary and appropriate.

(2) Switch references.

Use the Temporary Employment Frame: "If I were you for a day—how would I have to do that?" "Teach me how to do that."

(3) Anchor the experience.

Do it without using the kinesthetic system, use visual, auditory, language anchors.

(4) Slow the experience down and keep recycling.

Most subjective experiences go by too fast to catch all of the embedded patterns within it the first time. We see and hear much more when we see a fast-paced

movie the second and third times.
Recycling through the experience with the person to gather more information.

(5) Invite the person to step into and out of the experience.
Watch the difference between associated and less or different associated experiences.

Developing Mastering with Meta-Programs

1) Take each MP, *one at a time* and *practice each* one until you develop proficiency in recognizing and using it in speaking.
There's no need to overwhelm yourself with them, so refuse to do that to yourself.

2) Give yourself *permission* to hear Structure and move out of Content.
Go meta to listen for processing patterns. Does this make you self-conscious?

3) Use *open-ended questions* to elicit Meta-Programs.
"Would you tell me about one of your favorite holiday experiences?"
"What do you think about developing more effectiveness in communication skills?"

4) Some close-end question will work.
"Do you see this glass as half empty or half full?" can work well.

5) Use *downtime questions* to elicit Meta-Programs.
Any questions that requires a person to "go inside" to access the information which they need in order to respond. If they don't have the information "on the tip of the tongue," they will typically begin to also *demonstrate* their Meta-Program. And they *act it out* in various ways. So to elicit Meta-Programs simply ask a person to fully and completely recall something and have them then step into that experience and feel it fully as if there.

6) Remember, all MP do *not* all carry the same or equal weight of importance.
They differ according to how a person uses and values them in a given task or area. Identify context, and then *Prioritize* them in terms of importance to that person.
"Which MP is most important and impactful for this person?"
"What MP exercises the most significance in this person's experiencing?"

7) Use the Sorting Grid to track the MP.
This will help you organize them in your own thinking and memory.
Use it as a tool for profiling yourself first, then those you know well.

8) Practice Writing *Pacing Statements*.

Use the information as soon as you can. Practice writing matching statements.

This will greatly increase your communication skills.

If a person operates as a strong "Self" sorter (Self Referencing) who mismatches with counter-examples (or with polarity responses), he will tend to feel inclined to challenge people with "Prove it to me!" statements. This can spiral into a pointless matching of wits if you don't watch out. Yet knowing this, we can now counter this internal formatting with a pacing statement like:

"You seem so good at knowing your needs that only you can truly decide what you deem as ultimately right. No question about that. And I don't know if what I have to say will make any difference anyway. But anyway here it is."

#*1.* Eliciting a Positive Experience

1) Elicit a Positive Experience from Experiencer.

2) Groups of 3 invite Experiencer to talk about a positive event... tell about the experience when the person felt enthused, successful, brilliant, creative, decisive, a winner, etc.). Make sure the experience is a positive one.

3) Practitioners coach the Experiencer in order to elicit more and more of the experience with questions.

4) After 5 minutes, have Practitioners present the Experiencer a summary of their "reading" of his or her Meta-Programs. Check with A to determine the accuracy.

#*2.* The Sales Encounter

1) Groups of 4. Person who begins identify something that he or she would "never, but never buy."

2) Person B will then attempt to sell that very item to Person A.

As B attempts this "sell," the first Person should essentially consistently respond with a gentle refusal, just saying "No." "Not interested."

3) Person B should forge ahead regardless of A's verbal and non-verbal resistance.

4) During this, the two Meta-Persons will be writing down all of the Meta-Programs they can detect in both persons.

Pay special attention in detecting the linguistic markers within the language patterns of the persons.

#*3.* The Ideal Evening Game (Or, The Dating Game)

1) The Coach ask open-ended questions of your partner (the Experiencer) which essentially inquire about what makes for a great night out.

"What would you want to know about a person before you ask him or her out?"

"What would you need to know to have an evening out with a good friend?"

"What would you evaluate as a delightful evening out with someone?"

2) Create a list of all Meta-Programs that you detect in the other person's responses.

#4. Asking for Favor

1) Set a frame or context so that the Practitioner will aim to persuade the

Experiencer to do him or her a favor.

Ask an employee to do something... part of job or something extra.

Ask someone your in business with for a favor.

2) The Practitioner (or Coach) begins by asking ten questions of the Experiencer to identify his or her basic Meta-Programs.

Ask conversational questions to gather this information.

3) After gathering MP information, Practitioner will then frame his request (evoking his desired outcome) in words that will reflect the Experiencer's most compelling Meta-Programs.

4) Feedback for refining.
Afterwards, invite the Experiencer to gauge the effectiveness of the request and to offer feedback about how it could be made even more personally compelling for him or her.

#5. Asking For A Personal Favor

1) Set a frame or context for a Role Playing Situation in which one Person (the Coach) will persuade another Person (the Experiencer) to do a favor.

"I want you to go to the store for me to buy some milk."

"I want you to come over and watch my kids."

"I need $10."

2) As the Coaching Person persuades the the Experiencer, that person will remain unpersuaded and just say no.
3) The Meta Person will detect the meta-programs of the two players in the role playing situation.

4) At the completion, use the information gathered about each other's meta-programs to frame the request so that it's more influential.

#6. **The Experience of Liking** (2 people)

1) Practitioner will elicit from the Experiencer a time when he or she liked someone upon first meeting that person.

"How did you decide that you liked that person?"

2) (Use the Meta-Program list) Elicit as much information as possible about the Experiencer.
3) Repeat, doing the same for when the Experiencer disliked another person (a stranger, or now friend) upon first meeting him.

"How did you decide that you disliked that person?"

4) Explorers will feed back to Practitioner the meta-programs that he or she saw and heard and how the Experiencer responded in terms of meta-programs. Meta Person will also feed back to the Practitioner about how B displayed his or her

own meta-programs in the process. (5 min. and 5 min.)

#7. Identifying Someone's Agreement/Disagreement Signs

1) Groups of 3. Begin a discussion about something of interest with the Experiencer.

2) The 2 Coaches will watch for the Experiencer's autonomic nervous system signals of indicating *"Yes / No"* and *"Agree / Disagree."*

Elicit "yes" and "no" responses while calibrating to the subtle cues that indicate it even when they have no verbalization.

3) When as Coaches you feel that you have become calibrated to the Experiencer, ask that person to *not* respond verbally or demonstrate his or her thoughts-feelings in any *obvious* way.

Now verbally pace for 2 minutes to maintain rapport; then for 1 minute totally break rapport to get disagreement, and then for 2 minutes re-establish rapport.

Meta-Program Interviews:

Get with someone that you don't know and ask a series of questions to get them talking about something of importance to them until you feel that you have all of their most important meta-programs. Then begin to pace those meta-programs as you describe Neuro-Semantic mastery in terms of those filters.

Meta-Program Board Game

1) *Set Up.*

With 2 or more players, set out the Meta-Programs Board Game, along with the set of Meta-Program Cards.

2) *Cards.*

To begin the game, each player draws 5 of the cards. If you draw 2 of the same meta-program, put one back in the deck and draw another card.

3) *Moving on the Board.*

To move on the Meta-Program Board Game, role the dice and move your piece that number of squares.

4) Action.

The action begins whenever a player lands on one of the seven *Action Steps.* When you do, you will be asked to do one of the following:

Acting:

Act out a scene that exemplifies the 5 cards *without* saying any of the cue words of the meta-program. When the other participants have guessed the meta-programs you drew, then you can end the drama. *Penalty:* If you do mention a key word that gives the meta-program away, you have to draw 2 more cards.

Selling:

You are to interview for a job to the participant to your right and to do so *as if* you the 5 meta-programs govern the way you think and present yourself in the interview. You are *not* to mention the meta-programs or give obvious clues to them. The interview ends when the participant can name the meta-programs drawn.

Writing:

Write a love letter by speaking it out loud to an imaginary person who has these 5 meta-programs. Each time you've cycled through the 5 meta-programs, the other participants can guess them. When they are guessed, you can stop.

Relationship:

Plan a holiday with your partner to the right using these 5 meta-programs. When the partner can guess the meta-programs, the planning ends.

Coaching:

Coach an executive about time management issue who has these 5 meta-programs. The coaching ends when the participants accurately guess the meta-programs.

Speaking/ Training:

Give a presentation from these 5 meta-programs as if they were your own. The presentation or training ends when the participants guess accurately.

Profiling/ Modeling:

Question the player that you are least acquainted with for the purpose of elicit his or her meta-programs regarding the cards that were drawn. When you think you have the player's meta-programs, test your guesses.

5) Ending the Game.

The game continues until the first one crosses the finish line.

Advanced Practice — Constructing and Detecting Meta-Programs

1) Line up 3 people on one side of the table; 3 on the other side. Each will take turns being the constructors and the detectors.
2) Draw 3 or 4 cards — those who are constructing a statement use them to invent a statement that uses those meta-programs. Each writes for 2 minutes.
3) After 2 minutes each one presents their statement and the 3 who are detecting write on a paper the meta-programs that they are guessing are implied in the statement. Each reads ... may repeat 2 or 3 times, then the next person does the same, and then the third person.
4) Each of the Detectors presents their guesses and compare against the meta-programs.
5) Discuss the statements and the guesses.

IDENTIFYING
THE HIERARCHY OF VALUES

What we believe in as important, we value. We then speak about these as our *"values"* (nominalization). Yet values are not things, they are processes of evaluation, the standards we use to evaluate things, to make decisions about the importance of events, ideas, people, etc. Our values and criteria provide an organizing structure to our lives as well as a motivating force. As we add more and more values and criteria, the values themselves can begin to conflict with each other putting us at odds with ourselves. We can over or under value some things. When this happens, internal conflict can also occur so that we get out-of-balance.

The shift of values usually involve an analogue shift—adjusting the relative importance of the criteria instead of accepting or rejecting them wholesale. This technology becomes useful when we feel indecisive, can't make up our mind, experience lots of confusion, ambivalence, and inner conflict. We can also use it for resolving interpersonal difficulties, improving our decision making strategies, and before doing agreement frames.

The Pattern

1) Identify an area.

Think of one realm of life where values seem confusing (relationships, work, etc).

2) Elicit a hierarchy of criteria.

Think of something trivial that you could do, but you wouldn't (i.e. stand on a chair, throw a piece of chalk across the room). "Doing the dishes."

What do you accomplish by not doing this? I save time. (Always get the criteria stated in the positive —what the person wants.)

What would get you to do this even though it would violate that criteria?" (i.e. saving time, though a waste of time). If someone came for a visit.

So what do you find important about that? (As they keep adding more context, find out what the person values in that.)

Behavior	*Context*	*Criterion*
(-) Could do dishes, but won't	Few dirty dishes	Save time
(+) Would do dishes	& visiting stranger	Neutral impression
(-) Wouldn't do dishes	& cooking a meal	Excellence (of cooking)
(+) Would do dishes	& unhygienic dishes	Hygiene
(-) Wouldn't do dishes	& Crisis in building	Safety of persons

Continue this process of doing or not doing the particular behaviors by adding more and more context that gets a person to do the behavior or disengage from it —with each step identifying the criterion it exemplifies. “What stands important enough to get you to violate the previous criterion?”

Doing this will *elicit an outcome chain.* When would you do the first criteria (A), inquire, "What stops you" This will elicit some reverse or negative criteria (B).
Then recycle, When would you do A even through it causes B? This brings in the next higher level criterion (C). *Negative examples* in this process elicits more highly valued criteria. "When would you not do A even though it results in B or C?"

3) Identify the highest criterion and construct a hierarchy.

Continue until you have the most important criterion. Make a continuum from the least to the most important criterion.

4) Identify the Representational Code – what see, hear, feel?

Find the sub-modality differences between the least and the most important criteria.
How do you represent "saving time," "excellence," "safety of others," etc.?
Elicit see, hear, feel descriptions and especially the analogue “sub-modalities” that vary.

5) Put your criteria on a continuum.

Determine how much you want to reduce a particular criterion, where you want it to be on the scale. ?? Then shift the sub-modalities of that criterion so that it matches the “sub-modalities” of those at that lower place. Adjust the “sub-modalities” so that the criterion becomes coded for the degree of importance you want it to have. *??*

6) Ecology check.

Take a meta-position and evaluate your hierarchy of values.
Do they serve you well?
Do they fall into an order that enables you make good decisions, to create inner harmony?
Any problems or mis-alignments?
Identify the criterion you would like to change.

7) Shift criterion.

Identify the criterion to be shifted and determine where you want it to end up.
What order of values will get you where you want to go?

8) Test and Future Pace.

How does your value hierarchy look to you now?
Will it help guide you into right behaviors and decisions?
Think of a situation where the new criterion will make a difference to you and

put yourself into that context and notice your experience.

META-PROGRAMS DRIVER GRID

Use the following grid to identify someone's meta-programs. As a way of highlighting the most influential and the driving meta-programs in a given context, put a check mark (√) by the ones that are influential and an asterisk (*) by any meta-program that is a driver.

Mental Processing:

1) Representing: VAK — A_d _____
2) Sensor — Intuitor _____
3) Global — Specific details _____
4) Matching — Mis-matching _____
5) Counting — Discounting _____
6) Optimist (best) — Pessimist (worst) _____
7) Black-White — Continuum _____
8) Static — Process _____
9) Focus: Screening — Non-screening _____
10) Origins (why) — Solution (how) _____
11) Verbal — Non-verbal _____
12) Permeable — Impermeable _____
13) Causation: Linear, causeless, Complex, _____
Personal, Magical, Correlation _____
14) Closure — Non-closure _____
15) Quantitative — Qualitative _____
16) Focused — Diffused _____
17) Conformist — Non-conformist _____
18) Speed: slow, medium, fast _____

Emotional Filters:

19) Convincer Representation _____
20) Movie position: inside — outside _____
21) Desurgency — Surgency _____
22) Passive— Assertive — Aggressive _____
23) Authority: Internal — External _____
24) Attention: Self — Other _____
25) Em. Containment: Uni- — Multiple
26) Extrovert — Ambivert — Introvert _____
27) Active — Reflective — Inactive _____
28) Shrewd-Artful/ Genuine-Artless _____
29) Power, Achievement, Affiliation _____
30) Work: Independent, Team Player, Manager _____
31) Change: Closed — Open _____

32) Attitude: Serious — Playful _____

33) Persistence: Impatient — Patient _____

Choosing Filters

34) Convincer Demonstration: number, time _____

35) Motivation: Toward — Away From _____

36) Organization Style: Options — Procedures _____

37) Adaptation: Judger — Perceiver _____

38) Impossibility, Necessity, Desire, Possibility _____

39) People, Place, Things, Activity, Information _____

40) Goal: Skepticism, Optimizing, Perfection _____

41) Buying: Cost, Quality, Time _____

42) Social Convincer: Distrusting — Trusting _____

43) Competitive — Cooperative _____

44) Context: High (Inferential) — Low (Direct) _____

45) Management: Control, Delegate, Collaborative _____

46) Risk: Adversive — Embracer _____

47) Decision: Cautious — Bold _____

Semantic Filtering:

48) Self: Mind, Body, Emotions,. Roles, _____

49) Instruction: Compliant — Strong-will _____

50) Confidence: Low — High _____

51) Unconditional — Conditional _____

52) Integrity: Conflicted — Integrated _____

53) Responsibility: Under, Balanced, Over _____

54) Ego-Strength: Weak (unstable)—Strong (Stable) _____

55) Morality: Weak, Strong, Overly _____

56) Monitoring: Low external — high Internal _____

57) Time Zones: Past, Present, Future _____

58) In-Time Random — Through-Time Sequential _____

59) Quality: Be, Do, Have _____

60) List of Values _____

META-PROGRAM PROFILING SUMMARY

In the following, put a circle around the meta-program that you prefer. Put the number that you experience it from 0 to 10. If it is a driver meta-program, circle and put an asterisk (*).

THE COGNITIVE OR THINKING META-PROGRAMS:

#1. Representational:
Visual, Auditory, Kinesthetic, Language __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#2. Epistemological:
Sensors—Intuitors;
Experiencing, Modeling, Conceptualizing __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#3. Scope:
General Global — Detail Specifics __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#4. Relationship Comparison:
Matching Sameness — Mismatching Differences__ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#5. Information Staging:
Counting — Discounting __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#6. Scenario Type:
Pessimist — Optimist;
Worst — Best Case; Scarcity —Abundance __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#7. Classification Scale:
Black-and-white — Continuum __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#8. Nature:
Static — Process; __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program
Aristotelian — Non-Aristotelian

#9. Focus:
Screening — Non-screening __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#10. Philosophical:
Why (Origins) — How (Solution) __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#11. Communication Channel:
Verbal — Non-Verbal __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#12. Durability Sort:
Permeable — Impermeable __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#13. Causation:
Causeless, Linear, Complex, Personal,
External, Magical, Correlational __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#14. Completion:
Closure — Non-Closure __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#15. Information Kind:
Quantitative — Qualitative __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#16. Stream of Consciousness:
Focus — Diffused __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#17. Conventional:
Conformist — Non-Conformist __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#18. Speed:

Deliberate and Slow __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

Witty and Quick

THE EMOTIONAL META-PROGRAMS:

#19. Convincer Representation:

Looks, Sounds, or Feels Right — Makes Sense __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#20. Movie Position:

Associated feelings — Dissociated thinking;

Step in — Step out __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#21. Exuberance:

Desurgency — Surgency __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#22. Stress Coping:

Passive, Assertive, Aggression __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#23. Authority Source:

Internal — External __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#24. Attention:

Self — Other __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#25. Emotional Containment:

Uni-directional — Multi-directional __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#26. Rejuvenation:

Introvert — Balance — Extrovert __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#27. Somatic:

Reflective, Active, Inactive __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#28. Social Presentation:

Shrewdly artful — Artlessly genuine __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#29. Dominance:

Power, Achievement, Affiliation __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#30. Work Style:

Independent, Team player,

Manager, Bureaucrat __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#31. Change Adaptor:

Closed — Open;

Late—Medium— Early Adaptors __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#32. Attitude:

Serious — Playful __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#33. Persistence:

Impatient — Patient; Reckless — Persistent __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

THE CHOOSING META-PROGRAMS

#34. Convincer Demonstration:

Number of times

Length of time __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#35. Motivation Direction:

Toward — Away From; Approach — Avoidance

#36. Operational Style:

Options — Procedures __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#37. Adaptation:

Judging — Perceiving __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#38. Modus Operandi:

Necessity, Possibility, Desire,

Possibility, Impossibility __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#39. Preference:

People, Place, Things, Activity, Information __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#40. Goal Striving:

Skeptic, Optimization, Perfectionism __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#41. Buying:

Cost, Quality, Time __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#42. Social Convincer:

Distrusting — Trusting __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#43. Interactive:

Competitive — Cooperative

Win/Lose — Win/Win __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#44. Directness:

Inferential — Direct

High — Low Context __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#45. Management:

Control, Delegate, Collaborative __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#46. Risk Taking:

Fearful — Excitement;

Aversive — Embracer __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#47. Decision Making:

Cautious — Bold __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

THE SEMANTIC META-PROGRAMS

#48. Self-Experience:

Mind, Emotions, Choices, Body,

Dis-Identified, Spirit __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#49. Self-Instruction:

Compliant — Strong-Will __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#50. Self-Confidence:

Low — High

Conditioned on what skills? __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#51. Self-Esteem:

Conditional — Unconditional __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#52. Self-Integrity:

Conflicted incongruity —

Harmonous integrated __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#53. Responsibility:

Under-Responsible—

Healthy Responsibility

Over Responsible __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#54. Ego Strength:

Unstably Weak — Stable and Strong __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#55. Morality:

Weak, Strong, Overly strong

super-ego __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#56. Self-Monitoring:

Low — High;

internal — External __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#57. Time Zones:

Past, Present, Future __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#58. Time Experience:

In-Time Random —

Through-Time Sequential __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#59. Quality of life:

Be — Do — Have __ Degree of Intensity: 0 to 10 __ Driver Meta-Program

#60. Values:

What one deems important

QUESTIONS FOR ELICITING META-PROGRAMS

The Mental Meta-Programs:

Representation Style

1) When you think about something or learn something new, which sensory channel do you prefer—visual, auditory, or kinesthetic? Or do you prefer words and language over the senses?

__Visual
__Auditory
__Kinesthetic
__Language

2) When you listen to a speech or conversation, do you tend to hear the specific data given or do you intuit what the speaker must mean and/or intend? Do you want to hear proof and evidence since you take more interest in your intuitions about it? Which do you find more important Upon what basis do you make most of your decisions

Epistemology:
__Sensor
__Intuitor
—the actual or the possible?
—the practical or abstract possibilities?

What source of knowledge do you consider authoritative and most reliable? From where would you gather reliable information that you can trust? When you decide that you need to do something where do you get the information to do it from?

__Experiencing
__Modeling
__Conceptualizing
__Authorizing

3) When you pick up a book or think about attending a workshop, what do you pay attention to first—the big picture, book cover, or specific details about its value?

Scope:
__Global
__Specific

If we decided to work together on a project, would you first want to know what we generally will do or would you prefer to hear about a lot of the specifics?

4) How do you perceive things when you first attempt to understand something new to you? Do you look first for similarities and match up the new with what you already know? Or do you first check out the differences? Or do you first do one pattern and then immediately do the other?

Relationship Comparison:
__Matching Sameness
__Mismatching Differences
Matching with some Difference
Mismatching with some Sameness

5) What's your basic perceptual style when something good happens—do you count it or discount it? Do you acknowledge it and celebrate it or think about how it could have been better?

Information Staging:
__ Counting
__ Discounting

6) When you look at a problem, do you tend first to consider the worst case scenario or the best? The problems and difficulties or the opportunities and positive challenges?

Direction:
__Optimist
__Pessimist

7) When you think about things or make decisions, do you

Classification Scale:

tend to operate in black-and-white categories or does your mind go to the steps and stages that lie in between? Which do you value most?

__Black-White
__Continuum

Nature:

8) When you think about reality, do you tend to think about it as something permanent and solid made up of things or do you think of it as a dance of electrons, fluid, ever-changing, made up of processes?

__Aristotelian – Static
__Non-Aristotelian – Process

9) When you think about the kind of places where you can study or read, can you do this everywhere or do you find that some places seem too noisy or have too many of some other stimuli? Describe your favorite environment for concentrating on something? How distractible do you find yourself generally in life?

Focus:
__Screening
__Non-Screening

10) When you think about a subject (whether a problem or not), do you first think about causation, source, and origins (why), or do you think about use, function, direction, destiny (how)?

Philosophical:
__Origins/ Why
__Solutions/ How

11) When you think about communicating with somebody, what do you tend to give more importance to—what they say or how they say it? When you communicate, do you pay more attention to the words and phrases that you use or to your tone, tempo, volume, eye contact, etc.? When you hear someone say something that seems incongruent with how they express it, and you don't know which message to go with, which do you tend to favor as the more 'real' message?

Communication:
__Verbal / Digital
__Non-Verbal / Analogue

12) As you begin to think about some of your mental constructs, your ideas of success and failure, of love and forgiveness, of relationships and work, of your personal qualities, do you find the representations of what you know permanent or unstable? How can you tell? Think about something that you know without a doubt—about yourself. Now think of something that you know but with doubts and questions.

Durability
__Permeable
__Impermeable

13) What causes things? When something happens, good or bad, to you or a member of the family, what do you attribute it to? Luck, preparation, prayer, lots of things, etc.?

Causation:
__ Causeless
__ Personal
Complex Causal
__ External
__ Magical
__ Correlation

14) If, in the process of studying something, you had to break off your study and leave it, would this settle well or feel very disconcerting? When someone begins a story but doesn't complete it, how do you feel about that? When you get involved in a project, do you find yourself more interested in the beginning, middle, or end of the project? What part of a project do you enjoy most?

Completion:
__Closure
__Non-Closure

15) How would you evaluate your work as of today? How would you evaluate things in your relationship? How do you know the quality of your work? Upon what basis do you say that?

Information Kind:
__Quantitative
__Qualitative

16) How do you generally experience your flow of thoughts and emotions? Is it clear, focused, and concentrated or is it more diffused, scattered, and even "all over the place?"

Stream of Consciousness:
__ Focused
__ Diffused

17) How important is fitting in with others to you? How much of your mental time do you spend thinking about being accepted by others?

Conventional:
__ Conformist
__Non-Conformist

18) Are you a quick thinker and speaker? Do you typically jump to conclusions when you listen or read? Are you more of a slow and deliberate thinking who weighs things carefully?

Speed:
__ Slow
__ Medium
__ Quick

The Emotional Meta-Programs:

19) What leads you to accept the believability of a thing? Something about it looks right, sound right, makes sense, feels right to you?

Convincer Representation:
__Looks Right
__Sounds Right
__Feels Right
__Makes Sense

20) As you think about an event in a work situation that once gave you trouble. What experience surrounding work would you say has given you the most pleasure or delight? How do you normally feel while at work? When you make a decision, do you rely more on reason and logic or personal values or something else?

Movie Position:
__Associated feeling
Stepping in
__Dissociated thinking
Stepping out

21) When you think about a situation at work or in your personal affairs that seem risky or involving the public's eye, what thoughts-and-feelings immediately come to mind?

Exuberance:
__Desurgency, Timid, Controlled
__Surgency, Bold, Charismatic

22) When you feel threatened, or challenged, by some stress, do you immediately respond, on the emotional level, by wanting to get away from it or to go at it? Invite the person to tell you about several specific instances when he or she faced a high stress situation. Do you detect a "go at" or "go away from" response to it?

Stress Coping:
__Passivity
__Aggressive
__ Assertive

23) When you have to make up your mind about something, do you tend to look inside to decide or outside?

Authority:
__ Internal
__ External

24) Where do you put most of your attention as you move through the world, on yourself or on others?

Attention:
__Self-Reference
__Other-Reference

25) When you think about a time when you experienced an emotional state (positive or negative), does that bleed over and affect some or all of your other emotional states, or does it stay pretty focused so that it relates to its object?

Emotional Containment:
__Uni-directional
__Multi-directional

26) When you feel the need to recharge your batteries, do you prefer to do it alone or with others?

Rejuvenation:
__Extrovert
__Ambivert

__Introvert

27) When you come into a new situation, do you usually act quickly after sizing it up or do you do a detailed study of all the consequences before acting?

Somatic Response:
__ Reactive
__ Active
__ Reflective
__ Inactive

28) When you think about going out into a social group or out in public, how do you generally handle yourself? Do you really care about your social image and want to avoid any negative impact on others so that they recognize your tact, politeness, social graces, etc.? Or do you not really care about any of that and just want "to be yourself," natural, forthright, direct, transparent, etc.?

Social Presentation:
__ Shrewdly Artful
_Diplomatic
_ Artless Genuinely
Rough

29) Evaluate your motives in interacting with others in terms of your motivational preferences between Power (dominance, competition, politics), Affiliation (relationship, courtesy, cooperation) and Achievement (results, goals, objectives) and using 100 points as your scale, distribute those hundred points among these three styles of handling "power.

Dominance:
__ Power
__ Affiliation
__ Achievement

30) (A) Do you know what you need in order to feel and function more successfully at work?
(B) Do you know what someone else needs in order to feel and function more successfully?
(C) Do you find it easy or not to tell a person that?

Work Style:
__Independence
__Team Player
__Manager
__ Bureaucrat

31) How open or closed are you to change? Do you like or hate change? When things change, do you naturally want to resist or embrace it?

Change Adaptor:
__ Closed, late adaptor
Open, early adaptor

32) What is your basic attitude or disposition to life, playful or serious? Would others at work, home, business, sports, say that you are mostly serious or playful?

Attitude:
__ Serious
__ Playful

33) How patient or impatient are you when the pressure is on? When time pressures or other stresses rise, do you hold the course or become reactive and impatient?

Persistence:
__ Impatient, Reckless
__ Patient, Persistent

The Deciding Meta-Programs:

34) How many times does it take you before you feel convinced enough about a purchase to act on it and buy it? What length of time do you usually wait before purchasing something significant?

Convincer Demonstration:
__ Number of Times
__ Length of Time

35) What do you want in a job (relationship, car, etc.)? What do you want to do with your life?

Motivation Direction
__Toward, Approach
__Away From, Avoidance

36) Why did you choose your car? (or job, town, etc.).

Organization Style:
__Options
__Procedures

37) Do you like to live life spontaneously as the spirit moves you or according to a plan? Regarding doing a project together, would you prefer we first outline and plan it out in an orderly fashion or would you prefer to just begin to move into it and flexibly adjust to things as we go?

Adaptation:
__Judging, Controlling
__Perceiving, Releasing

38) How did you get up this morning? What did you say to yourself just before you got up?

Modus Operandi:
__Necessity
__Possibility
__Impossibility
__ Desire

39) What would you find as really important in how you choose to spend your next two week vacation? What kinds of things, people, activities, etc. would you want present for you to evaluate it as really great? Tell me about your favorite restaurant.

Preference:
__People
__Place
__Things
__Activity
__Information
__ Systems

40) Tell me about a goal that you have set and how did You go about making it come true? If you sat a goal today to accomplish something of significance, how would you begin to work on it?

Goal Striving:
__Skepticism
__Optimizing
__Perfection

41) What do you tend to primarily concern yourself with–the price, time, or quality, or some combination of two of these when you consider making a purchase?

Buying:
__Cost
__Time
__Quality

42) When you think about meeting someone new, do you immediately have a sense of trust and openness to the person, or thoughts and feelings of distrust, doubt, questions, jealousy, insecurity, etc.?

Social Convincer:
__Distrusting
__Trusting

43) When you come into a situation, how do you usually respond? Is it with a sense of cooperation or competition? How competitive are you? What would others say about you? Do you respond with a sense that you want others to win or to lose?

Interactive:
__Competitive
__Cooperative

44) How direct or indirect are you in your communications? Do you often imply things or listen in terms of what you infer from others?

Directness:
__ Inferential, High Context
__ Direct, Low Context

45) What is your style of managing or directing others? Do you like to control, delegate, or seek collaboration from the group? What's your preference? What do you feel most natural doing?

Management:
__ Control
__ Delegate
__ Collaborative

46) How much of a risk-taker are you? What is your basic attitude and response to risks in life?

Risk Taking:
__ Fearful, Adversive
__ Excitement, Embracer

47) How decisive or indecisive are you. Do you make decisions on the spot in a self-assured way, or are you more cautious and indecisive?

Decision:
__ Indecisive, Cautious
__ Decisive, Bold

The Semantic Meta-Programs

48) How do you experience yourself in terms of your mind, emotions, body, roles?

Self-Experience:
__Mind
__Emotions
__Body
__Roles
__ Disidentified

49) Can someone "tell" you or order you to do something? How do you think and feel when you receive 'instructions?'" "How well can you "tell" or order yourself to do something and you carry it out without a lot of internal resistance about it?

Self Instruction:
__Strong-Will
__Complaint
__ Balance

50) As you think about some of the things that you can do well and that you know, without a doubt, you can do well and may even take pride in your ability to do them well, make a list of those items. How confident do you feel about your skill in doing these things?

Self-Confidence:
__High Confidence
__Low Confidence

51) Do you think of your value as a person as conditional or unconditional? When you esteem yourself as valuable, worthwhile, having dignity, etc. do you do it based upon something or view it as a given?

Self-Esteem:
__Unconditional
__Conditional

52) When you think about how well or how poorly you live up to your ideals and in actualizing your ideal self, do you feel pretty integrated, congruous, doing a good job in living true to your values and visions or do you feel torn, conflicted, un-integrated, incongruous?

Self-Integrity:
__Conflicted, Incongruent
__Integrated, Congruent

53) When you think about having and owning responsibility for something in a work situation or personal relationship, what thoughts and emotions occur to you? Has someone ever held you responsible for something that went wrong that felt very negative to you? What positive experiences can you remember about someone holding you responsible for something?

Responsibility:
__Over-Responsibility
Balance, Dependable
__Under-Responsibility

54) When you think about some difficulty arising in everyday life, a disappointment, problem, frustrating difficulty that will block your progress, etc., what usually comes to mind? How do you typically respond to internal needs or external hardships?

Ego Strength Sort
__Unstable, Weak
__Stable, Strong

55) How conscientious are you? When something goes wrong that you were involved in, do you start examining yourself, what you did, what you can do to make amends? How easily can you admit an error and face up to it? How sensitive is your conscience?

Morality/ Consciousness:
__ Overly strong super-ego
__ Strong super-ego (Balance)
__ Weak Super-ego

56) How well do you know yourself? How often do you monitor yourself, your emotions, states, thoughts, beliefs, etc.?

Self-Monitoring:
__ Low, External
__ High, Internal

57) Where do you put most of your attention—on the past, present, or future? Or, have you developed an atemporal attitude so that you don't attend to "time" at all?

Time Tenses
__Past
__Present
__Future

58) Do you represent "time" as coming into you and intersected with your body, or outside of yourself and body?

Do you represent 'time' as coming into you and intersected with your body, or outside of yourself and body?

Time Experience
__In Time
__Through Time
__Random
__Sequential

59) What is the central focus of your life, on what you do, what you have, or your sense of being? If you put doing, being, and having into a circle, how much percentage would you put on each focus?

Quality of Life:
__ Being
__ Doing
__ Having

60) As you think about this X (a thing, person, event, experience, etc.) what do you evaluate as valuable, important, or significant about this?

Value:
List Values

NLP AND META-STATES
AS MODELS AND SYSTEMS

What does it take to have a true model? How does NLP work as a system? Here are the necessary and sufficient pieces that comprise a model.

	NLP —	META-STATES
1) A Theory:		
A theoretical background, foundation, hypothesis, etc. that offers an explanatory model for how the model or system works, the governing ideas and how to test and refine the ideas in order to create new applications.	The NLP Ps. (Presuppositions	Meta-Level Principles
Ideas that can be tested and falsified	Map/ Territory	Levels of Abstraction
Answers *Why* Questions	Gestalt Psychology	Cognitive Psychology
Epistemology	Constructionism Meta-Cognition	
		Batesons' Cybernetics
		Korzybski
2) Variables and Elements:		
The pieces and parts that make up the components of the model.	VAK	Meta-Levels
Answers the *What* Questions.	Language	Self-Reflexivity
What elements are absolutely necessary and sufficient to make the model work?	Meta-Programs	Recursive Feedback
	"Sub-modalities" loops	
What processes?		Feed forward loops
		System Functions
3) The Guiding and Operational Principles:		
The "laws" or principles (presuppositions) that define and articulate the mechanisms that make it work and how to use them in a methodological, systematic, and systemic way.	Adaptation of NLP Ps.	Meta-Level Principles
	TOTE Model for Strategies	Thinking in feedback loops to track the recursive flow of mind
This gives one the ability to keep refining the model.		Higher Frames govern.
		Self-organizing theory
Answers the *How* questions:		Principles of Systems
How does the model work?		
What processes, mechanisms govern it?		
4) The Technologies or Patterns:		
The specific tools that provide immediate application for using the Model or System to achieve something.	The 150+ NLP Patterns	The 140+ NS Patterns
Answers *how to* questions:		
How do you reframe meaning? Etc.		

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L. Michael Hall is a psychologist who is continuing the modeling of self-actualization that Abraham Maslow began. Beginning with his work in Cognitive psychology, he discovered the field of NLP and worked for awhile with Richard Bandler, the genius behind the NLP model. Then modeling resilience he discovered the Meta-States model that because the most significant contribution to NLP in the 1990s. That led to the creation of the field of Neuro-Semantics and later, with Bob Bodenhamer, the creation of the *International Society of Neuro-Semantics.* Since the early 1990s, he has modeled leadership, learning, selling, wealth creation, and then coaching. That led to the founding of the Meta-Coach Training System with Michelle Duval. When he began modeling Self-Actualization Psychology for Meta-Coaching, that led to the Self-Actualization Quadrants and other models.

Today Michael is a visionary leader in the field of Neuro-Semantics and Self-Actualization Psychology. He works as an entrepreneur, researcher/modeler, and international trainer. His doctorate is in the Cognitive-Behavioral sciences from Union Institute University. He had a therapy practice in Colorado for fifteen years and then found NLP (1986) and then wrote several books with Richard Bandler. As a prolific writer, Michael has written more than 35 books, many best sellers in the field of NLP and today has written more books about NLP than anyone in the field. Michael first applied NLP to coaching in 1991, but didn't create the beginnings of Neuro-Semantic Coaching until 2001 when together with Michelle Duval co-created Meta-Coaching trainings. In 2003, the Meta-Coach Foundation was create.

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